A SPACE-FANTASY ROLEPLAYING GAME

LANTERN REACH

Frontier Guide

Open Horizons / creatures, worlds and nine adventures



OPEN HORIZONS / ALPHA 0.3.1 / PLAYTEST EDITION

An original space-fantasy adventure RPG.
Pantheons. Strange worlds. A crew of your own.

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Using this book

Open Horizons is an original manuscript expansion for Lantern Reach. Use the original Player's and Guide's books for the core 2d6 rules. This volume adds material; it does not replace the core resolution engine.

GUIDE SPOILERS: read the player-facing choices before running these adventures. Six scenarios form two playable arcs; three independent expeditions add a vault crawl, a wilderness hunt and a legendary siege. Further continuation jobs are clearly labeled preparation frameworks.

The Explorer's Expansion contains player options, rites, equipment and ranks 11-20. The Frontier Guide contains creature profiles, twelve destinations, nine keyed adventures and campaign procedures. The two books share a short expedition charter so either volume explains compatibility.

Choose the expansion scope together before introducing new options. The offline companion supports the original core options and ranks 1-10; expansion characters use paper sheets or notes. The companion does not calculate these new identities or high-rank abilities.

Species, present body, profession, religious tradition and citizenship are independent choices. Pantheons remain central without making every adventure a religious struggle. The frontier includes rescue, discovery, politics, ecology, trade and ordinary working life.

This material has editorial and production checks, not completed live tabletop playtests. The rank extension, new powers and encounter combinations require table testing. No claim of proven balance or commercial breadth is made.

Readiness and ownership

Players own their characters' beliefs and choices. Agree on tone before play and pause when needed. No rule forces religious conviction, personal disclosure or one predetermined solution to a scene. A Guide gives concrete opportunities and consequences, then lets the crew choose its route.

Open Horizons / Expedition charter

Open Horizons expands Lantern Reach into a longer space-fantasy campaign game. It adds character options, a larger power library, equipment, creatures, a frontier atlas and two adventure arcs. Use the original Player's and Guide's books for core resolution. Everything here is original tabletop material, independent of proposed Manifest Destiny / ROZ canon.

This is a manuscript expansion, not proof of competitive balance. Its options work on paper with the existing 2d6 rules. The offline companion currently implements the original rank 1-10 options; it does not calculate these new Lineages, Vocations, Disciplines, rites or rank 11-20 features. Use a paper sheet or notes for expansion characters. Never import an unsupported identity and assume the app retained it.

Choose the campaign's scope

At campaign start the table chooses Core or Open Horizons. In Open Horizons, all players may choose the new character options. A player may keep a core character without penalty. Existing campaigns can adopt the expansion between adventures; each player may exchange one Vocation, Discipline, Embodiment or starting rite package once, preserving rank, wounds, gear and earned relationships. This is a transition allowance, not repeatable tactical rebuilding.

The three Pantheons remain Order, Ancients and Divinity. Additional religious orders are schools, institutions or communities within or across those traditions, not extra mechanical Pantheons. Secular commitments remain possible interpretations of personal Creeds. No society is assigned a compulsory body, faith or class.

What is in the expansion

Library	New material	Use
Peoples and bodies	Four Lineages, three Embodiments, eight Provenances	Broader identity without species/class restrictions
Vocations and Disciplines	Six Vocations; three Disciplines with foundations and electives	Twelve total Vocations and eight total Disciplines across core and expansion
Rite codex	Forty-five rites across the three Pantheons	Combat powers, exploration, rituals and high-rank choices
Ranks 11-20	Ten ranks, legendary undertakings, institutions and long projects	Larger stakes without escalating attributes or extra attacks
Equipment and vessels	Weapons, tools, relics, vehicles and three more ship frames	New approaches and logistical decisions
Frontier bestiary	Thirty-six individual adversary/creature profiles	Opposition, wildlife, allies and component bosses
Frontier atlas	Twelve destinations, connected routes and faction institutions	A campaign beyond the starter sector
Broken Beacon / Choir Below	Six keyed adventures in two arcs	Low/middle-rank rescue politics and high-rank frontier discovery
Independent expeditions	Three more keyed adventures	Relic-vault crawl, wilderness hunt and legendary siege evacuation
Zone maps	Nine printable vector maps	Numbered areas and alternate routes for all new adventures
Campaign procedures	Research, negotiation, faction projects, settlements and encounter assembly	Repeatable play between and within adventures

Rules that still apply

Revision 0.3.1 also adds the core **Push** choice: 1 activation Strain for +1 damage to one target or +1 task progress on success, declared before a personal strike, damaging hostile rite or task action. Sum activation Strain before Fracture; Push changes effect rather than dice. Brief observance now takes ten peaceful minutes once/expedition, restoring personal Conviction to 3 without a downtime project. The core rules govern timing and exclusions. Six field wonders enrich expedition rewards without adding another currency.

Roll 2d6 + one attribute + at most one relevant expertise + net situation capped at -1/0/+1. Attributes remain capped at +3. One move and one action per activation, one supplied reaction per round. No universal opportunity attacks. Use core damage order and Downed rules. Conviction remains 3, Strain fractures at 4, wounds retire at 3. Ordinary temporary Guard is at most 1 and does not stack. Supply remains 8 and Stores 6 unless a particular vessel explicitly provides a separate cargo space; cargo never increases those resource caps.

Duration: “next turn” means the end of the affected character's next turn unless the power says otherwise. “Scene” means a meaningful change of objective or pressure, not another room. Once/scene and once/session limits attach to the named

feature. Two copies of a named effect never stack; only the stronger applies. Features that add a target never add another action. A character cannot use two reactions on the same trigger.

Resources: pay activation costs before rolling. Sum one activation's Strain costs per payer as one packet, resolve any Fracture, then continue if able. Result Strain occurs afterward as a separate packet. No refund unless stated. A protected or successful action never automatically refunds a rite's Conviction. New abilities cannot create Supply, Stores, permanent followers or unlimited healing from nothing.

Choices: all new Lineages, bodies, Vocations, Disciplines and Pantheons combine freely. Starting equipment accommodates the chosen body. A feature permitting an unusual task does not grant a generic numerical bonus. An ability affecting a willing target requires real consent, not a successful social roll. Rites and psionics cannot settle another character's religious beliefs.

A first expansion session

For rank 2-4, begin with The Broken Beacon. Use core ready explorers or new characters made with the same attribute array, starting Guard and milestone budget. Choose one of the new Provenances if desired. Start the crew with a core Courier, 4 Supply, 4 Stores and 2 Accord. Read only the player options actually selected and the first adventure. The entire library is not homework.

For rank 6-10, begin with The Choir Below. Give each explorer normal group-rank advancement, two ordinary equipment purchases totaling at most 3 Supply and one studied relic chosen with the Guide. That allowance happens once at campaign creation. Do not grant a private ship or independent Supply pool per character.

Conversion record

Write the enabled expansion chapters on the first page of the campaign log. List each chosen option and its rules source. When a rule is unclear, record the table ruling and review it after the session. Do not silently replace an option mid-scene or remove a player's established ability because a later manuscript changed. An expansion character is ready when another player can explain their action, costs, limits and recovery without relying on the author.

06 / Frontier bestiary

Thirty-six profiles supply different tactical problems, needs and encounter roles. A creature is not necessarily an enemy. Religious affiliation, biological engineering, mechanical continuity and psionics are not villain categories. Any sapient profile can be represented by different peoples without changing its statistics. Give named people actual motives and choices.

Reading a profile

Personal-scale NPCs use listed Guard, armor and damage. They take one move plus one action per activation, alternating with PCs. An Attack is a normal core enemy attack: its target defends with Force to brace or Finesse to evade and describes the approach. A special Action replaces the ordinary attack; no bonus turn. One reaction per round only when explicitly supplied. All otherwise have no special reaction. At 0 Guard they are defeated and the fiction determines surrender, flight, incapacitation or destruction; NPCs do not automatically use PC wound tracking.

Special actions without damage state exactly how to resist or escape. No profile may turn a missed PC roll into another free enemy activation. Area attacks target at most the listed number and allow a separate defense for each. A countdown advances only on its explicitly announced trigger. If an effect lacks a listed automatic repetition, it does not repeat.

For first encounters use one regular per PC at most, or one elite plus one regular for three/four PCs. Objective pressure, terrain and combinations can make even that too much. Duets use one regular at a time with escape available. “Elite” and “boss” are design roles, not validated challenge ratings. A boss's components are listed under its profile and are not additional hidden creatures.

Wildlife and ecological hazards

Glassback Grazer

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close shove, damage 2.

Action - Scatter: move one zone away from a visible heat source instead of attacking; any creature deliberately blocking its only open route is attacked normally on a later activation, not for free now. It protects a salt lick rather than hunting people.

Counterplay: open another route, extinguish the heat or leave its feeding zone. Loose mineral plates can be collected after it sheds; killing it produces no automatic Supply. Found at Kestrel's Garden and Stillwater Crown.

Coilwing Scavenger

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 3. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close talons, damage 1.

Action - Snatch: target one visible unattended hand-sized object in its zone; carry it to an adjacent accessible perch. A held object is ineligible. It is attracted to reflective packaging and flees rather than fighting once wounded.

Counterplay: cover loose gear, offer a decoy or retrieve the object through a climbing task. Flight crosses only connections actually open to an animal its size. Enclosed hatches block it; its body is not valuable treasure.

Siltjaw Ambusher

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 6. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close bite, damage 2.

Action - Mud Hold: one target in its zone defends against an ordinary close attack; instead of damage, a failed/partial defense pins the target until it spends an action freeing itself. Successful defense avoids the hold. The Siltjaw cannot bite and hold in the same activation.

Counterplay: disturbed silt reveals the approach; retreat to dry ground or drive it off with loud vibration. It is defending a submerged nest. Its pin does not automatically drown a character or cancel their actions.

Lantern Moth Swarm

Scale: personal, regular swarm. **Guard:** 4. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** own-zone irritating cloud, damage 1 to one target.

Action - Follow the Light: relocate to an adjacent zone containing the brightest exposed ordinary lamp. It does not occupy several zones or make free attacks on entry. A sealed suit prevents irritation but not obscured sight.

Counterplay: switch light sources, use a shielded lamp or create a dark bypass. Ordinary weapons affect its Guard normally; area descriptions do not grant free extra damage. A preserved specimen can identify a nearby ecological disturbance.

Ridge Burrower

Scale: personal, elite. **Guard:** 10. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close crush, damage 3.

Action - Undermine: announce one ordinary ground connection in its zone cracking. At the end of its next activation that connection becomes difficult terrain unless it leaves, is defeated or someone completes a 2-segment brace task. Undermine replaces the next attack if it completes then. No instant buried PCs.

Counterplay: its vibration precedes emergence by a round. Move to reinforced ground, brace the route or lure it away using a loud unattended tool. It cannot tunnel through ship hulls or solid reactor shielding.

Choir Reef Colony

Scale: personal, regular stationary organism. **Guard:** 6. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close irritant tendril, damage 1.

Action - Resonance: mark its zone as loud until its next turn. Ordinary unprotected spoken/radio signals there cannot carry detailed messages; wired links or prepared hand signals still work. No mind control or automatic Strain damage.

Counterplay: reduce nearby industrial vibration, use a resonant decoy in another connected pool or isolate the colony behind a physical screen. It needs moving oxygenated water; destroying it may contaminate a settlement's filtration supply.

Constructs and engineered systems

Maintenance Spider

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 4. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close clamp, damage 1.

Action - Seal Worksite: lock one ordinary maintenance hatch it can reach. An authorized terminal opens it; otherwise use a 2-segment device task. It cannot close a hatch occupied by a creature or seal a hull breach instantly.

Counterplay: display a valid work order or disconnect its visible command cable with an action in its zone. It then idles. A salvageable tool head can substitute for a missing ordinary repair tool, not create Supply.

Customs Lens

Scale: personal, regular stationary device. **Guard:** 3. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** none.

Action - Transmit Flag: advance an announced Inspection countdown by 1 if a visibly uncredentialed traveler remains in its zone. Default countdown 4; on completion one regular port officer arrives from a named entry next round. This device never fires a weapon.

Counterplay: legitimate credentials, a recognized appeal, visible power isolation or an ordinary protected-system task. Destroying it leaves obvious evidence and does not erase a completed transmission. A port may be concerned with safety rather than punishment.

Sentry Tripod

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** ranged pulse, damage 2.

Action - Reorient: select one visible adjacent zone as its new firing arc. It cannot fire outside that arc until another Reorient. Starting arc is announced when first seen. It has no movement and cannot attack during Reorient.

Counterplay: use cover, flank through another connection or disable the visible power feed by a 2-segment task. Its security owner may authorize a shutdown. No automatic attacks on movement between turns.

Rescue Automaton

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 6. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close nonlethal restraint, damage 1.

Action - Extract: carry one willing or unconscious human-scale creature from its zone into an adjacent designated safe zone. Its safety registry may be outdated; the Guide announces the destination before movement.

Counterplay: provide current environmental data through a 2-segment interface task or block the route with an ordinary obstacle. It does not become malicious because it is mechanical. It can be an ally once its instructions match present conditions.

Salvage Walker

Scale: personal, elite. **Guard:** 10. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close cutting arm, damage 3.

Action - Cut Support: begin a visible 2-stage cut through an ordinary human-scale brace in its zone. A second uninterrupted activation completes it instead of attacking. Announce the resulting dropped barrier or closed connection; creatures have a full round to leave the marked area.

Counterplay: interrupt the cutter, move it away, cut its trailing power lead or supply an updated salvage exclusion. Its chassis is too heavy for ordinary forced movement but its exposed lead is not armored.

Archive Sentinel

Scale: personal, elite. **Guard:** 8. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** ranged suppression pulse, damage 2.

Action - Index Lock: close access to one ordinary archive terminal it can reach until its next turn. A user may spend an action presenting a relevant credential or use a different terminal. It does not erase records or hack sentient bodies.

Counterplay: learn the archive's actual access categories, show a valid deposit record or physically disconnect that terminal's security link. The Sentinel values record integrity more than pursuing intruders beyond the archive.

People in conflict

Charter Bailiff

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close shock baton, damage 1 nonlethal.

Action - Serve Notice: explain one enforceable local order and offer a concrete compliance route. No roll or imposed mental condition; characters can refuse. If threatened, it uses normal attacks on future activations.

Counterplay: produce evidence of an exemption, negotiate time, seek an appeal or leave its jurisdiction. The Bailiff can be mistaken without lying. It carries documents and a communicator, not automatically confiscatable magic treasure.

Dockside Lookout

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 4. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** ranged sidearm, damage 2.

Action - Signal Crew: advance an announced Reinforcements clock by 1; default 3, summoning one regular from an identified berth next round. It needs a working communicator and can signal instead of firing, never both.

Counterplay: cut the local channel, offer a better reason to keep quiet, or move out of the observed zone. A rumor, debt or fear may explain its allegiance. Killing it is not required to stop a warning.

Contract Breacher

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 6. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close blade, damage 2.

Action - Pressure Entry: advance a visible 4-segment breach task by 1 at a reachable ordinary door. Completed breach opens a traversable connection; defending/repairing it requires an action and plausible tools. No free attack through the opening.

Counterplay: flank it, negotiate the contract, secure a second brace or disconnect its powered cutter. It follows a specific paid objective and can withdraw if the objective becomes unavailable or the employer defaults.

Gene-Sculpted Runner

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** ranged carbine, damage 2.

Action - Vault: move two connected zones instead of attacking, through openings that fit it. This is its entire action plus ordinary move; it cannot make a third move afterward. Suit, pressure and exposed-route dangers apply.

Counterplay: close a hatch, protect the intended destination or intercept its cargo socially before pursuit. Engineered mobility is a bodily adaptation, not evidence of a religious or political allegiance.

Psionic Smuggler

Scale: personal, regular. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** ranged sidearm, damage 2.

Action - Distracting Pulse: one conscious target in its zone chooses to step into an adjacent safe zone or take 1 Strain. The target chooses; if no safe route exists it can remain and take Strain. No forced thought, memory alteration or compelled attack.

Counterplay: keep distance, interrupt line of perception or offer a nonviolent cargo inspection. It cannot use the pulse and fire on the same activation. If the target's Strain fractures, use normal rules rather than an invented domination state.

Veteran Expedition Leader

Scale: personal, elite. **Guard:** 9. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** ranged carbine, damage 2.

Action - Cover Their Exit: one conscious willing ally in its zone may move one safe zone, without an attack or action. The Leader gains ordinary cover if suitable terrain exists. No extra activation for either.

Counterplay: offer a safe withdrawal, expose a failed contract or contest the rescue objective instead of chasing kills. It does not fight to death for minor salvage. Its map and testimony may be more useful than its equipment.

Unusual phenomena

Static Echo

Scale: personal, regular phenomenon. **Guard:** 4. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** own-zone discharge, damage 1.

Action - Repeat Signal: replay one genuine recorded sound from its zone. The Guide labels the source medium; it cannot invent a truthful message or impersonate an unrecorded person. It is not established as a soul.

Counterplay: isolate the physical conductor or complete a 2-segment grounding task. That ends the phenomenon regardless of Guard. Weapons can break its visible emitter but may destroy the recording the crew wants.

Gravity Knot

Scale: personal, regular stationary phenomenon. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close pull, damage 2.

Action - Bend the Route: announce one ordinary loose-object path drifting toward the Knot until its next turn. Unsecured unattended objects move on its next activation instead of an attack. Creatures are never moved without a normal defended attack or a stated voluntary choice.

Counterplay: anchor gear, shut down its exposed field source through a 4-segment task or route around it. Shooting the field is ineffective unless targeting its identified physical source, which uses this Guard.

Mirror Bloom

Scale: personal, regular organism/phenomenon. **Guard:** 4. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** none.

Action - Double Image: cast a visible static duplicate of one recorded shape in its zone until its next turn. Examination/touch reveals projection; it supplies no damage, automatic evasion or mind control.

Counterplay: shade its light-sensitive fronds, ground its power-bearing soil or distinguish reflected images using an ordinary scanner. It feeds on illumination; preserving the colony can reveal a route marked by earlier explorers.

Hunger Fog

Scale: personal, regular mobile hazard. **Guard:** 5. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** own-zone corrosive exposure, damage 2 to one target.

Action - Follow Warmth: move one zone toward an exposed heat source instead of attacking. It is a cloud of reactive micro-organisms with a visible condensed core; damage to that core uses the listed Guard. No immunity to all weapons by description.

Counterplay: seal a hatch, cool a route or distract it with a powered heat tool. A compatible sealed suit prevents ordinary chemical exposure until damaged, but not loss of visibility. Fire may endanger the whole habitat and is not a free universal solution.

Pilgrim Light

Scale: personal, regular projection. **Guard:** 3. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** none.

Action - Lead On: move a visible projected guide into one adjacent traversable zone. Its stored route may end at a damaged location. Following is a player choice; no charm roll compels it.

Counterplay: inspect its mobile emitter, compare the route to present terrain or replace the stored destination. It can guide a rescue once corrected. Destroying it ends the effect but loses its incomplete travel log.

Phase Scar

Scale: personal, elite stationary installation failure. **Guard:** 10. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** adjacent-zone field burst, damage 3 to one target.

Action - Charge: mark one visible zone. On its next activation it may burst in that zone instead of charging again; creatures can leave or shut down a visible regulator first. It cannot hit an unmarked zone and never bursts automatically at round end.

Counterplay: a 4-segment regulator task shuts it down intact; smashing its exposed source defeats it but destroys a route calibration record. No character disappears from reality as a random missed-roll consequence.

Apex threats and component bosses

Dune Sail Leviathan

Scale: personal, boss animal. **Guard:** 14. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close sweep, damage 3 to at most two targets in its zone, separate defenses.

Action - Sand Wake: mark one adjacent ground zone; on its next activation either enter that zone and attack one target normally or remain and cancel the wake. No free end-round damage. It can have only one marked zone.

Counterplay: reach elevated foundations, remove a painful embedded survey beacon with a 4-segment task, or lead it toward a suitable feeding ground. It retreats once the beacon is removed or after losing 7 Guard. It is not an evil faction or a compulsory trophy hunt.

Cathedral Walker

Scale: personal, component boss. **Guard:** 12 core. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close foot sweep, damage 3 to one target.

Components: two exposed knee regulators, Guard 4/armor 0 each. Disabling either removes its ordinary move; disabling both exposes an emergency hatch and permits a 2-segment shutdown task. Each regulator also has a reachable manual latch requiring a 2-segment task instead of damage. Components have no activations.

Action - Warning Horn: mark its own zone; its next activation may sweep two targets there instead of one, or cancel the warning to move. Destroying the horn through an ordinary reachable-device task cancels a pending double sweep.

Counterplay: board the maintenance stair, open latches or negotiate with the caretaker operating it. It has one enemy activation per round, not one for every component. Its sacred architecture does not establish divine approval of its actions.

Borrowed Crown

Scale: personal, component boss operated by a person. **Guard:** 10 core. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** ranged arc, damage 3.

Components: amplifier Guard 4/armor 0 and power reservoir Guard 5/armor 0. The amplifier can instead be disconnected by a 2-segment task in its zone; without it the arc reaches own zone only. The reservoir has a manual 4-segment isolation procedure; without it the Crown cannot use its special action. Neither component activates.

Action - Overload: mark one visible zone; its next activation may make one normal arc attack there and then take 2 core damage ignoring armor. Otherwise cancel the mark. No extra attack or automatic Strain packet to everyone.

Counterplay: show the operator the overload risk, isolate power or offer surrender terms. The person can leave the device voluntarily; then use an ordinary unarmored regular profile, Guard 4 and damage 1, if another conflict is actually needed.

White Current Hunter

Scale: personal, elite aquatic animal. **Guard:** 10. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** close bite, damage 3.

Action - Circle: move to one adjacent connected water zone and gain ordinary cover from actual submerged terrain if available. Attacking next turn ends cover normally. It cannot become untargetable through narration.

Counterplay: leave the water, establish a barrier or remove the sonic lure drawing it into traffic. Its water habitat imposes ordinary environmental requirements on PCs, not a flat penalty to all their rolls. At half Guard it seeks escape.

Ashfall Siege Rig

Scale: personal, component boss vehicle at a fixed worksite. **Guard:** 14 core. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** adjacent-zone stone launcher, damage 3.

Components: loader Guard 4/armor 0 and track pin Guard 4/armor 0. Disabling the loader replaces its ranged attack with a close damage-2 ram; disabling the track prevents movement. Each has a visible 2-segment mechanical release task. Components have no turns.

Action - Range Marker: mark one visible adjacent zone. Next activation it may attack up to two targets there, separately defended, instead of its ordinary attack. It cannot mark and launch on the same turn.

Counterplay: cross behind real cover, cut the ammunition route or convince its crew that the target district is occupied. One activation per round. It is not a full capital war machine that a sidearm can destroy from orbit.

Archive Swarm Director

Scale: personal, elite controller. **Guard:** 9. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** close defense pulse, damage 2.

Action - Reassign Drone: move one existing willing/non-sentient linked Maintenance Spider to an adjacent traversable zone. That drone gains no action or extra activation. The Director cannot create replacements from nothing.

Counterplay: disconnect its visible local antenna with a 2-segment task or resolve its missing archive order. Run at most two Spiders with it for a first four-PC encounter; their own activations count in the enemy total. Destroying records may make a diplomatic resolution harder, not automatically impossible.

Ship-scale opponents

These six use **Hull**, not Guard. A PC at a relevant station makes the core station roll. Crew station actions resolve first, then the enemy vessel takes **one** ship action. Its Attack is a possible enemy action, not an extra shot after a maneuver. Player-pilot opposed Maneuver rules still apply. Personnel aboard are separate encounter profiles if boarded. At Hull 0 use disabled-ship consequences and rescue options; never automatically kill everyone.

Customs Cutter

Scale: ship. **Hull:** 9. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** gun at Engagement 2-3, damage 2.

Action - Demand Inspection: request shutdown, credentials and a stated cargo review. If refused it may maneuver or attack on later ship actions, not immediately for free. Its published jurisdiction can be challenged.

Counterplay: demonstrate authorization, offer a neutral berth inspection, break pursuit normally or disable its communication link through an accessible boarding task. Cargo records, not scrap, are its primary interest.

Sable Pursuer

Scale: ship. **Hull:** 8. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** gun at Engagement 2-3, damage 2.

Action - Close the Gap: attempt the core enemy Maneuver opposed by the player pilot to raise Engagement by 1. It cannot fire in the same action. At Hull 4 or lower it offers a ceasefire for a specific cargo concession.

Counterplay: use debris/route tasks to create an edge for the pilot, bargain over the actual contract or force a withdrawal. It cannot follow through a sealed route merely because pursuit would prolong the encounter.

Quiet Mine Tender

Scale: ship. **Hull:** 7. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** defense gun at Engagement 3, damage 1.

Action - Lay Warning Mine: mark the present route segment with one visible ordinary mine. On a later attempted passage the pilot can avoid it through the announced route task or take damage 2 once. The mine is a hazard, not another ship activation; it does not explode immediately on creation.

Counterplay: scan the field, take an extra leg or disable a reachable mine through a ship Engineering/Scan task with stated stakes. Its crew may sell a genuine clearance code if given protection from their employer.

Refuge Convoy Tug

Scale: ship. **Hull:** 10. **Armor:** 0. **Attack:** improvised gun at Engagement 3, damage 1.

Action - Shield the Tow: place itself between a physically connected disabled ship and one declared attacker. Until its next ship action, one attack aimed at that tow targets the Tug instead, with normal pilot defense. No automatic damage cancellation or unlimited interception.

Counterplay: negotiate safe separation or repair its tow. It is normally an ally or rescue objective, and attacking it has concrete human consequences rather than granting extra combat rewards.

Relay Warden

Scale: ship-scale stationary platform. **Hull:** 12. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** beam at Engagement 2-3, damage 3.

Action - Charge Beam: mark one visible ship. On its next action it may fire at that ship if still in reach; otherwise discharge harmlessly. It cannot fire an uncharged beam. A successful exposed-coupling Scan/Engineering task with a 4-segment objective disables the beam intact.

Counterplay: change range, dock through a real blind maintenance approach or produce a valid shutdown order. Personnel can board the platform through two keyed zones; a mobile component does not grant it a move.

Hollow Ark

Scale: ship-scale component encounter. **Hull:** 14 core. **Armor:** 1. **Attack:** defense gun at Engagement 3, damage 2.

Components: exposed comm array Hull 4/armor 0; docking governor Hull 4/armor 0. Each also has a reachable 4-segment boarding shutdown task. Components have no enemy ship actions. The comm array controls ordinary remote commands; the governor controls docking clamps.

Action - Lock Berth: if an adjacent cooperating or already clamped ship is physically connected, keep its clamp locked until the governor is disabled or a 4-segment local override completes. Cannot seize a free-flying ship automatically.

Counterplay: negotiate with the people in the Ark, board via maintenance, isolate the array or disengage before clamps close. The climax is deciding who controls its habitat system, not destroying an inhabited vessel for loot.

What victory yields

Before an encounter, decide which usable asset or information the participants actually carry. Ordinary recovered equipment is a replacement or sale opportunity, not unlimited Supply. A meaningful salvage cache is usually 2 Supply after finding a buyer; a negotiated contract ordinarily pays 3-4 as in core rules. Defeating a creature grants no automatic currency or milestone by itself. Escaping, rescue, negotiation and shutting down a dangerous system can fulfill the same mission objective as combat.

07 / Atlas of the farther Reach

Twelve destinations extend the starter sector. They are original tabletop proposals, not established Manifest Destiny / ROZ geography. Each has multiple communities and affiliations. A name such as “Choir” describes a local institution or history, not a fourth mechanical Pantheon. The crew can travel, work, study, celebrate, trade or investigate without joining a territorial campaign.

Connected routes

One listed leg costs 1 Stores and an ordinary travel watch under core rules. A two-leg route costs two; a shelter buoy between legs is not automatically a fuel seller. Routes are bidirectional unless a temporary fictional event closes one. No random roll is needed for ordinary charted travel. Offer an announced hazard or choice when something materially changes.

From	To	Legs / useful fact
Meridian Anchorage	Ashfall Harbor	1; registered rescue channel
Ashfall Harbor	Stillwater Crown	1; surface shuttle connection at arrival
Stillwater Crown	Morrow Spindle	2; unstaffed shelter buoy between legs
Morrow Spindle	Pale Accord	1; customs asks intended docking district
Pale Accord	Lacuna Archive	1; records of access must be booked
Lacuna Archive	Redoubt Nine	2; no fuel at the intervening listening buoy
Redoubt Nine	Viridian Steps	1; approach needs the current storm forecast
Viridian Steps	Threnody Basin	1; ecological sampling restrictions are public
Threnody Basin	Vesper Choir	1; scheduled public convoy twice each local week
Vesper Choir	Saffron Wreck	1; salvage approach has marked debris lanes
Saffron Wreck	Winter Index	2; sealed emergency shelter at the halfway marker
Winter Index	Halcyon Deep	1; deep approach beacon must be checked before descent
Halcyon Deep	Quiet Glass	2; recovered survey route, no public fuel en route
Redoubt Nine	Ashfall Harbor	2; patrol channel, alternate return path
Vesper Choir	Pale Accord	2; commercial bypass, reserve passage before departure

Full refueling and ordinary repair are available at Ashfall, Morrow, Pale Accord and Vesper. Stillwater, Redoubt, Viridian and Winter sell Stores when their listed local problem does not interrupt supply. Lacuna, Threnody, Saffron and Halcyon

normally have no public fuel. State shortages before departure so logistics create choices rather than surprise impossible journeys.

Destinations

Ashfall Harbor

A coastal city beneath a ring of dormant launch towers, built to redirect ordinary seasonal ash from nearby geothermal fields. Humans of several bodies work alongside Oruun and Koruun builders; neighborhood politics matter more than a species majority. Order engineering schools maintain the ash baffles, an Ancients mutual-aid kitchen receives stranded travelers, and secular harbor unions operate the tug fleet.

Facilities: full fuel/repair, clinic, ordinary gear and ground crawlers. **Contact:** Sella Venn, a gene-crafted human structural inspector and Order dissenter. She wants an honest public repair assessment rather than an excuse to privatize the harbor.

Pressure: an obsolete rescue beacon is broadcasting a false safe approach. The harbor council has evidence but cannot agree who should pay for replacing it. **Jobs:** recover its original calibration plate; escort a disputed inspection team; deliver clinic air filters before an ash front. **Secret the Guide can reveal:** the false signal is an old automated safety mode, not deliberate religious sabotage.

Stillwater Crown

A shallow ocean world whose floating towns attach to enormous old mineral rings. Nacrean marine cooperatives, human Continuant divers and Tessari broadcast artists share local institutions. The rings are infrastructure and contested heritage, not proof that one culture owns the planet.

Facilities: limited fuel, skiffs, compatible aquatic shelter, sample laboratory. **Contact:** Tesh-of-Many-Windows, a Tessari harbor storyteller who follows Divinity and documents the families displaced by a failing ring.

Pressure: White Current Hunters are following a submerged industrial lure into occupied waters. **Jobs:** remove the lure without flooding a district; map a submerged public passage; settle rival claims over a salvage barge. **Discovery:** ring maintenance inscriptions preserve several competing calendars, suggesting generations of shared reconstruction rather than one vanished master civilization.

Morrow Spindle

A rotating shipyard and market built around a decommissioned engine spindle. Its districts have different gravity arrangements and require deliberate access design. No body has universal ease everywhere. The spindle houses interfaith observance rooms, a secular fabrication guild and contentious labor courts.

Facilities: full fuel/repair, modules, interface adapters, pressure-compatible clinics. **Contact:** Pavo Ren, an unmodified human dock organizer and secular constitutionalist, who refuses to treat shrine membership as a labor credential.

Pressure: an Archive tender carrying wage records is impounded under two contradictory contracts. **Jobs:** authenticate the records, guard a public hearing, retrieve a lost work order from a dangerous sealed bay. **Complication:** both signatories acted within different recognized jurisdictions; exposing a forged signature will not alone solve the legitimate debt.

Pale Accord

A neutral treaty habitat at the meeting of three commercial routes. Public plazas deliberately host incompatible architectural traditions. Mechanical persons can hold citizenship under the same local charter as biological residents, while visitors still argue over what evidence of continuity should count.

Facilities: full fuel, mediators, ordinary gear, registered research contracts. **Contact:** Asha Korr, an augmented human Envoy, Ancients lay observer and elected treaty clerk.

Pressure: a water-shipment guarantee will expire while an arbitrator is missing. **Jobs:** find the arbitrator, secure a replacement witness or negotiate an extension openly. **Local rule:** weapons are peace-bound in hearing rooms; this is an institution's rule with public appeals, not universal law across the Reach. **Discovery:** a stored message reveals the arbitrator left voluntarily to investigate an unsafe cargo contract.

Lacuna Archive

Several linked vault habitats preserve maps whose gaps are as significant as their contents. Ilyri climatologists, Asteri evidence conservators and human records cooperatives operate rival catalogs. Religious institutions sponsor some collections; other collections criticize those same institutions.

Facilities: temporary shelter, record study, no public fuel or general shipyard. **Contact:** Ir-of-the-Third-Shelf, a mechanical Asteri archivist who values public access but refuses to expose private medical records.

Pressure: a credential migration has mistaken a deposited community history for abandoned corporate property. **Jobs:** restore the deposit chain, find the original community representative, or negotiate a public copy while preserving private testimony. **Danger:** Archive Sentinels close terminals under conflicting orders. **Discovery:** the missing Halcyon route is divided among three ordinary storage formats, not encoded in a hereditary bloodline.

Redoubt Nine

A former military observation post now shared by a refugee council, a weather service and a rescue cooperative. Its defenses are useful against storms but costly to maintain. The name does not make residents militarists; many have spent their lives dismantling the old command hierarchy.

Facilities: Stores, basic repairs, surplus ordinary gear, docking shelter. **Contact:** Mera Sol, a human Continuant veteran who follows Divinity and runs the evacuation registry.

Pressure: a Relay Warden still accepts obsolete exclusion orders. **Jobs:** board it through a blind maintenance approach; recover a recognized civilian shutdown document; protect a hearing about who will operate the relay afterward. **Complication:** shutting the relay off removes both weapons and a useful storm warning channel unless separately rerouted.

Viridian Steps

Terraced settlements climb an equatorial ridge where distinct local ecologies meet. Several Warden schools share field stations with industrial surveyors. Communities disagree about sampling, grazing and settlement expansion within every religious tradition.

Facilities: limited Stores, shelters, biological tools and compatible vehicle rentals. **Contact:** Nami Pell, a Symbiotic human Surveyor and Ancients keeper who believes fieldwork should employ local apprentices.

Pressure: a Ridge Burrower displaced by a drilling test is threatening the only dry evacuation path. **Jobs:** relocate the test rig, establish another route or help remove an embedded survey beacon from the animal. **Discovery:** a planted “sacred grove” is actually a successful old filtration experiment; its cultural importance need not diminish because it also has an engineering explanation.

Threnody Basin

A deep inland sea resonates with human-made harbor structures and native Choir Reef colonies. Vibration carries navigation information but also disrupts breeding grounds. Researchers, pilots and residents disagree about safe schedules, not about whether the sea belongs to a single chosen people.

Facilities: rented shelter, skiffs, water-compatible workshop; no public fuel. **Contact:** Vey Saren, a Nacrean acoustics engineer, Order architect and parent of a missing survey apprentice.

Pressure: an experiment is drawing Hunger Fog toward the harbor intake. **Jobs:** recover the experiment log, retune a decoy, rescue a crew trapped below the sonar dock. **Discovery:** the "voice below" is a layered public signal assembled from years of ordinary recordings. People can still attach religious meaning to who preserved them and why.

Vesper Choir

A route-city built around scheduled communication windows. Its name predates the present religious institutions. Broadcast halls host music, civic announcements, prayers, commodity reports and criticism of all of them. Cantors, Ciphers and transmitter workers share crews.

Facilities: full fuel/repair, signal tools, archives, public assembly spaces. **Contact:** Jo Leth, a psionically attuned human broadcaster and secular free-signal organizer.

Pressure: a paid emergency channel is carrying an old distress loop while a current habitat asks for rescue. **Jobs:** identify the genuine present coordinates; persuade the channel operator to yield airtime; deliver a portable relay through a blocked maintenance hall. **Complication:** the archived message is a family member's last record, and deleting it is unnecessary to open a second channel.

Saffron Wreck

The accessible remains of a migratory station, inhabited by salvagers and descendants of its former passengers. Yellow industrial dust gives it its name. It contains homes, shrines, workshops and abandoned sections; it is not an ownerless treasure chest.

Facilities: traded parts, shelter by arrangement, no public fuel. **Contact:** Haru Tal, a Koruun Modular mechanic who follows Order and negotiates worksite boundaries for the resident council.

Pressure: a salvage license includes occupied modules because the registry uses a century-old map. **Jobs:** complete a current occupancy survey, secure an appeal before demolition or remove residents from a genuinely failing module. **Danger:** a Salvage Walker follows the mistaken map. **Discovery:** its sealed bridge holds the Winter Index route alongside a maintenance debt that still has a living claimant.

Winter Index

A cold storage habitat orbiting a dim world, maintaining seed libraries and ordinary agricultural reserves. Dormancy here means preserved organisms and stored records; no rule establishes effortless resurrection or uploaded immortality. Food cooperatives and research institutions share custody.

Facilities: limited Stores, sealed refuge, preservation tools and sample study. **Contact:** Elian Moss, an Ilyri Chirurgeon with an augmented body and Divinity affiliation.

Pressure: a cooling failure forces a choice between collections unless crews restore a physical bypass. **Jobs:** recover a replacement pump from a sealed store, compare conflicting catalog priorities or escort a public redistribution team. **Discovery:** one vault contains a viable Halcyon ecological sample whose removal needs a careful transport plan, not a chosen-person ritual.

Halcyon Deep

An old habitat-engine complex beneath dense cloud and pressure. Its reachable maintenance decks support ordinary compatible suits and refuges; deeper layers require specialized infrastructure and a separate expedition. The site is inhabited, poorly mapped and connected to contemporary communities through incomplete records.

Facilities: emergency shelter only after securing life support; no public fuel. **Contact:** Suri An, a human mechanical maintenance coordinator and Ancients observer, who wants both existing residents and arriving claimants heard.

Pressure: the docking governor accepts an obsolete ownership token while its people need a new water intake. **Jobs:** repair the intake, recover a recognized access record, negotiate control of the habitat engine and decide where its next route should open. **Discovery:** the complex can redirect one local transport corridor; it cannot rewrite the galaxy or settle which Pantheon is true.

Eight institutions with competing projects

All have human members of several bodies alongside nonhuman members. Joining one never determines Lineage, Embodiment or Vocation. Begin Trust at 0 unless the campaign establishes a prior relationship. Use core Trust -2 to +2 and the campaign project procedure. “Resource” means access they actually control, not a free income for membership.

Institution	Public purpose / material resource	Current disagreement	Reachable offer
Harbor Compact	Civic port councils; tugs, repair berths and public work records	Whether emergency harbor repairs justify private tolls	Repair access for a completed inspection, materials still cost Supply
Lattice Fellowship	Order engineering and observance schools; brace crews and archives	Some favor licensed central control; others teach public maintenance	A teacher for an Order rite after a service or study interval
Returning Seed Houses	Ancients mutual-aid refuges; ecological records and guest rooms	Whether fragile habitats can accept another convoy immediately	Safe ordinary rest while the crew helps solve a concrete capacity problem
Open Lantern Assembly	Divinity civic and religious gatherings; interpreters and treatment volunteers	Whether to publish a painful emergency testimony without its speakers' consent	A willing mediator and a legitimate public hearing space
Meridian Continuity Union	Cross-faith personhood and labor association; legal advocates and repair contacts	Biological/engineered/Continuant members disagree over proof standards	An introduction for a continuity or employment dispute; no body-exclusive rights
Peregrine Survey Exchange	Scientific chart sharing; instruments and field stations	Open data versus protecting endangered sites from exploitation	A calibrated instrument loan with return terms
Sable Contract League	Shipping and armed commercial escort; vessels and creditor records	Captains split over protecting crews versus enforcing profitable salvage claims	Paid passage or a negotiable contract, not mandatory antagonism
Free Signal Circles	Secular and religious public broadcasters; relay access and copied records	Open access versus protecting private testimony	One ordinary transmission slot if it does not endanger another emergency

Rumors that lead somewhere

Roll or choose one when the crew asks for work. A rumor provides a reachable lead, not a forced mission. Two independent sources can verify or contest it.

d12	Report	First concrete lead
1	Ashfall's beacon has chosen who may land	Compare its physical calibration plate to the harbor weather record
2	A diver at Stillwater heard their future voice	Inspect the old recording buoy feeding the ring speakers
3	Morrow's court sold a whole crew	Obtain the impound order and interview a crew representative
4	Pale Accord's arbitrator vanished into a locked room	Ask the public transit clerk about a voluntary departure
5	Lacuna remembers every private thought	A terminal lists only deposited recordings and their access categories
6	Redoubt's gun fires only at one religion	Compare obsolete ship credentials across the actual target list
7	Viridian's grove is artificial and therefore worthless	Visit both its filtration intake and its community memorial
8	Threnody's sea is demanding a sacrifice	Trace the experiment's acoustic power pattern
9	Vesper has two emergencies on one channel	Find the second transmitter in the maintenance register
10	The Saffron Wreck has no living owners	Ask its current resident council to show you their map
11	Winter Index preserves dead gods	Inspect the publicly cataloged seed chambers and a restricted biological sample
12	Halcyon can open any star	Recover the local route governor's specification and test its actual range

Travel encounter assembly

Choose a location, one active need, one party already trying to solve it, and one pressure that changes while the crew acts. Introduce no more than one combat encounter per ordinary leg unless the group deliberately enters a hazardous route. Encounters can be a failed coolant shipment, a seasonal migration, a creditor requesting records, a beacon needing a repair or a community inviting travelers to a feast. Make a destination desirable before threatening it.

08 / The Broken Beacon arc

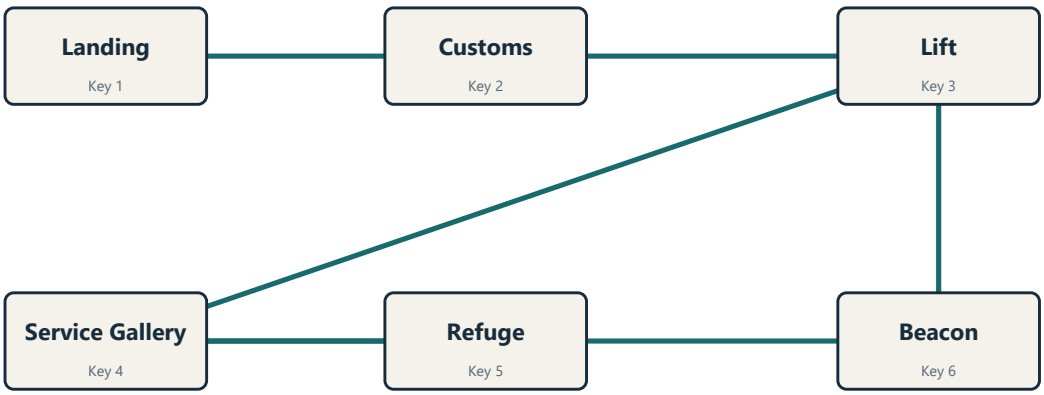
An opening frontier arc for two to four rank 2-4 explorers and one Guide. Each adventure takes roughly one or two sessions depending on table pace. They can stand alone. A rescue crew receives a faulty approach signal, finds the same obsolete registry behind a wrongful impound, then decides who should operate a repaired relay. The problem is institutional neglect and competing needs, not an evil religion.

Read core resolution first. Task clocks gain 1/2/3 progress on partial/full/exceptional success. State task risks before rolling; an ordinary failed task here makes no progress and adds 1 Strain unless a keyed area states a different consequence. Do not also invent an enemy attack. Unopposed ordinary interactions need no roll. NPC stat profiles are in the Frontier Bestiary; a scene summary identifies which to use.

Adventure 8: The Broken Beacon

The Broken Beacon

Open Horizons / Adventure 8 / keyed zones



Ash Front begins only after the safe work watch. Refuge is sealed shelter.

ZONE PLAY / NOT TO SCALE / Only named zones are junctions.

Place: Ashfall Harbor. **Rank:** 2-3. **Opening:** a rescue tug nearly strikes a tower after following the public beacon. Inspector Sella Venn offers 3 Supply to recover its calibration plate and restore a trustworthy approach before the next ash front. The tug crew will testify voluntarily. Agree whether the expedition includes a general harbor repair; this job pays for the beacon work only.

People: Sella wants a public maintenance record, not a scapegoat. Tug pilot Rem Varo, a human Continuant and secular union member, wants their crew cleared of negligence. Dock supervisor Hal Es, an Oruun Order architect, initially fears exposing a cost-saving delay but will release tools if shown the false signal.

Map: Landing -> Customs -> Lift -> Beacon. Lift -> Service Gallery -> Beacon. Service Gallery -> Refuge. All are bidirectional human-scale connections. Landing has cover; Refuge has sealed ordinary shelter. Climbing between Lift and Beacon without power needs a tether and a 2-segment route task; it is not a second free connection.

1. **Landing:** the damaged tug supplies a genuine recording of the beacon discrepancy. Inspecting it reveals a timestamp conflict without a roll. The crew can borrow an anchor web if they promise to return it. A public weather panel states one safe watch remains before the ash front.
2. **Customs:** one Charter Bailiff asks for a work authorization. Sella's message is valid; showing it resolves the stop. Without it, the Bailiff offers a reachable call to Sella or a recorded emergency appeal. Violence is optional and causes a specific later hearing, not automatic sector-wide hostility.
3. **Lift:** ordinary power is interrupted. A 4-segment repair task restarts the lift; Force with a winch or Insight with tools are plausible. A failed attempt exposes a hot connector: take 1 Strain, no extra damage. A tethered route through the Gallery bypasses the lift.
4. **Service Gallery:** one Maintenance Spider is sealing the old worksite. Show the current work order, disconnect its command cable or defeat it (Guard 4, armor 1, close damage 1). Its screen displays that the beacon is using a century-old safety profile. This is the second independent clue.
5. **Refuge:** two conscious workers shelter here with a hand-copied calibration checklist, the third clue. They can explain the old profile but will not leave until a safe route exists. Escorting them needs movement, not a compulsory Care roll. A pressure patch and ordinary communicator are available if returned afterward.
6. **Beacon:** complete a 6-segment calibration task using any two of the recording, Spider log and checklist to identify the discrepancy. The brass plate itself is readable proof and can be removed with an action. Recalibration can be performed without removing it; the crew chooses what evidence goes public.

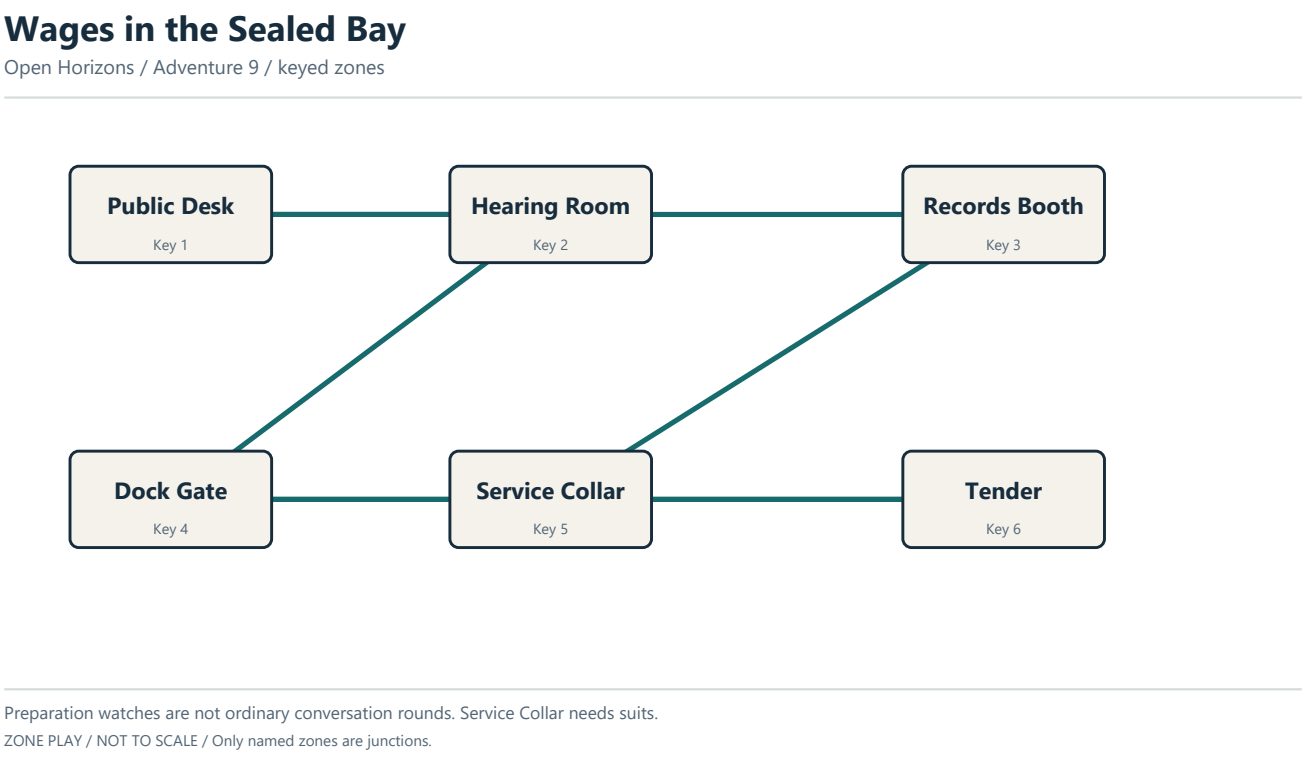
Pressure: at the end of the one announced safe work watch, ash arrives. Thereafter, only during an active exposed beacon emergency, advance **Ash Front 6** once at round end. At 6 the exterior route closes until the storm passes, not instant death. Refuge stays safe. Damaging the antenna or publicly disconnecting beacon power also stops false guidance but leaves arrivals waiting; it is a valid partial solution.

Opposition: the Spider is the only default enemy. For four experienced PCs, add one Sentry Tripod at Beacon with a published obsolete firing arc; both machines accept the valid emergency shutdown. For a duet, keep one Spider and reduce calibration to 4. Do not run the storm clock during ordinary customs conversation before ash actually arrives.

Outcomes: verified calibration or a documented safe shutdown earns 3 Supply and Harbor Compact Trust +1. A storm delay reduces payment to 2 but preserves evidence and leads; explain this term before acceptance. The plate's old registry points to the impounded Archive tender at Morrow Spindle. If all physical evidence is destroyed, the tug witnesses and a surviving public beacon log still establish the next lead.

Wonder: the Refuge crate contains a Promise Engine, also pictured on the Lift's diagram. The workers will explain its socket and allow ten peaceful minutes of study before ash closes in. One minute +1 Conviction powers one intact ordinary human-scale utility for a watch, once per physical Engine per expedition. It can run the Lift without repairing the feed, opening that route; it does not also calibrate Beacon. They give it to the crew in thanks after rescue. It counts as a readied relic and cannot run weapons or a whole ship. Its recorded maintenance promise names a missing caretaker, a usable next personal lead. Full rules are in Wonders and discoveries.

Adventure 9: Wages in the Sealed Bay



Place: Morrow Spindle. **Rank:** 3-4. **Opening:** dock organizer Pavo Ren hires the crew for 4 Supply to recover the tender's lawful wage ledger before an impending salvage auction. The task is to protect the crew's claim, not decide whether any creditor may ever collect. The bay contains legitimate secured debt and an invalid declaration that the crew abandoned the vessel.

People: Pavo prioritizes workers' access to their earnings. Creditor Tessa Mire, an augmented human Ancients observer, paid for emergency repairs and wants a credible repayment schedule. Captain Orr Talen, a Veyran Divinity adherent, withheld the crew's distress message because they feared losing their command. Each can concede something without changing religion.

Map: Public Desk -> Hearing Room -> Dock Gate -> Tender. Public Desk -> Records Booth -> Service Collar -> Tender. Dock Gate ↔ Service Collar. Tender is ordinary personal scale while docked; it does not take ship turns during the investigation.

1. **Public Desk:** obtain the hearing schedule and two conflicting registry entries freely. One records repair custody, the other abandonment; neither proves intent. Pavo supplies a valid wage-deposit receipt, sufficient to begin an appeal.
2. **Hearing Room:** Tessa offers inspection in return for a written promise not to destroy collateral. A concrete guarantee, neutral witness or orderly supervised inspection can secure agreement without rolling. If trust is genuinely uncertain, use a 4-segment negotiation task; a failure costs one preparation watch, not mind control. Her nonnegotiable need is preservation of the repair claim, not immediate cash.
3. **Records Booth:** a Customs Lens has restricted the older message archive. Valid deposit credentials provide access. Otherwise a 4-segment protected-system task can reveal the distress timestamp, with failure advancing **Inspection 3** by 1. At 3 one Charter Bailiff arrives next round and offers a review; it does not start automatic combat.

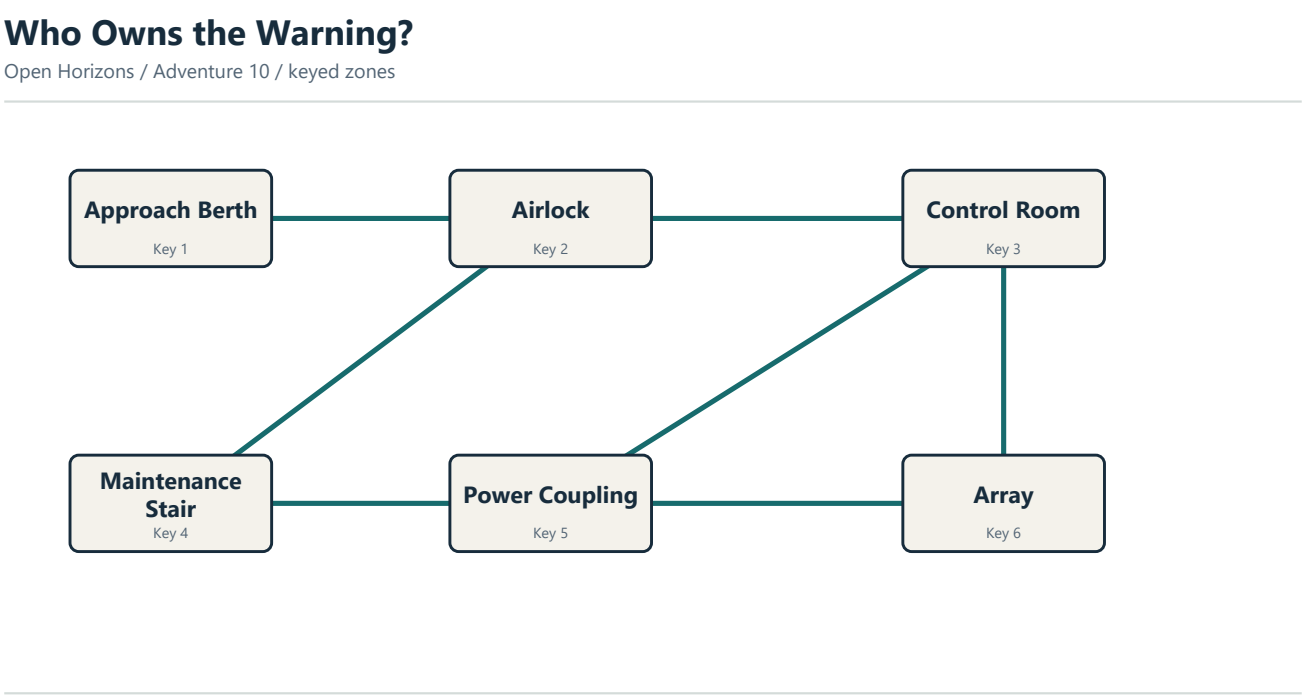
4. **Dock Gate:** one Contract Breacher (Guard 6, armor 1, close damage 2) is hired to preserve the vessel. It accepts a written inspection agreement or a court-stamped emergency order. If attacked, it tries to close the gate before harming workers and withdraws if its employer revokes the contract.
5. **Service Collar:** an unpowered access route fits suited explorers. A 2-segment tether task makes it safe; failure takes 1 Strain. A witness-marked panel preserves the distress message relay receipt even if the main archive is lost.
6. **Tender:** the wage ledger is intact and freely copied with a recording kit once access is gained. A failing coolant line puts the physical archive at risk. Complete **Coolant Bypass 4** or use a cold vault; destruction loses the original but not an already copied record. Captain Orr can admit withholding the message when shown either relay receipt or timestamp.

Pressure: the auction begins after **three explicitly tracked preparation watches** spent on failed negotiation, long research or deliberate delay. Ordinary dialogue and crossing a zone do not consume watches. At auction, the vessel moves into escrow; evidence can still win wages, but recovering the hull requires a new agreement. There is no automatic sale of people or cancellation of personhood.

Clues: the public abandonment entry, message archive and relay receipt each independently point to a stale registry signed by Redoubt Nine. Recovering any one gives the next lead. For a duet reduce protected-system/coolant tasks to 2, retain the single Breacher and give Pavo the core companion profile if requested.

Outcomes: a certified copy plus a wage hearing earns 4 Supply and the crew's testimony. An agreement preserving Tessa's legitimate repair claim can also raise Trust with the Sable Contract League. If the tender remains impounded, the crew still gets paid for the record; the next job is not locked behind buying a ship. A violent escape leaves an appeal and restitution problem rather than ending the campaign.

Adventure 10: Who Owns the Warning?



Place: Redoubt Nine and its relay platform. **Rank:** 4-5. **Opening:** rescue coordinator Mera Sol offers 4 Supply and local repair access to stop the relay rejecting civilian ships with obsolete credentials. The relay also carries real storm warnings; indiscriminate destruction would solve one danger by creating another.

People: Mera wants an accountable civilian warning service. Relay caretaker Fen, a mechanical human Order dissenter, will accept new authority if someone actually assumes maintenance. Weather analyst Ri Aven, an Ilyri secular scientist, needs the environmental data preserved. Two local councils disagree over staffing and fees; neither represents an entire species.

Map: Approach Berth -> Airlock -> Control Room -> Array. Airlock -> Maintenance Stair -> Power Coupling -> Array. Control Room ↔ Power Coupling. The exterior Stair needs suits and anchors; the inhabited Control Room has ordinary air.

1. **Approach Berth:** before docking, show the relay's published exclusion message and identify the blind maintenance approach. A Customs Cutter is holding off, not attacking. It will escort a documented inspection if the crew presents the stale registry evidence or Mera's current request.
2. **Airlock:** Fen answers through a functioning intercom. A maintenance promise with named caretakers, a current civilian authorization or physical emergency access opens the route. A 4-segment latch task is possible; failure adds 1 Strain and visibly alerts Fen, with no free beam attack indoors.
3. **Control Room:** the target list shows obsolete credential formats across several religions and bodies. It is not a targeted theological purge. Copying it is automatic. Fen can explain shutdown, reclassification and data-routing alternatives.
4. **Maintenance Stair:** loose anchors create a 2-segment route task. Bypassing the room through here reaches the Coupling without fighting Fen. A core companion can hold the tether while the PC acts in duet play.
5. **Power Coupling:** a 4-segment isolation task disables the beam while leaving sensors alive. Brute-force destruction of the exposed coupling also works but cuts both systems. A successful Scan or Surveyor reading identifies that consequence before anyone commits.
6. **Array:** complete **Route Warnings 6** to copy the weather feed onto Redoubt's public channel, then choose the relay's governance. A written crew/council maintenance agreement, independent operator or restricted civilian joint board are all legitimate outcomes. No single social roll binds the councils forever.

Pressure: only if an external ship remains in a declared hostile firing arc, run the Relay Warden in ship scale: Hull 12, armor 1, damage 3 beam requiring its prior Charge action. During boarding use one personal-scale Sentry Tripod at the Array, not simultaneous unannounced beam damage to PCs. For four PCs add a Maintenance Spider; for a duet omit the Tripod if Fen has not been attacked and reduce Route Warnings to 4.

Resolution: disabling the beam while preserving a working weather channel earns 4 Supply, Harbor Compact Trust +1 and a willing relay contact. A documented emergency shutdown earns 3 with a follow-up repair commitment. Destroying the platform saves immediate targets but leaves a real weather-service gap; offer a repair/portable-relay expedition rather than withdrawing all future jobs.

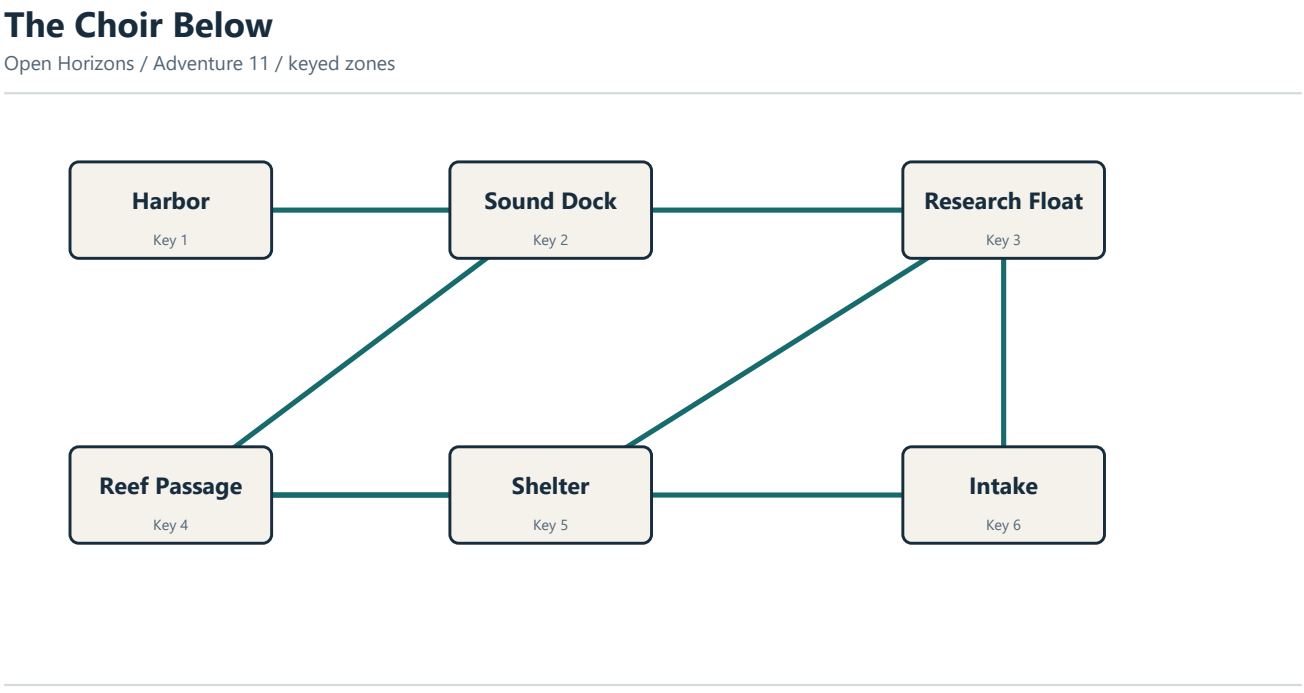
Arc continuation: the clean weather feed contains an ordinary maintenance request from Threnody Basin and coordinates for Vesper Choir. These lead to the second arc. Alternatively the crew can return home, follow a personal thread or explore the atlas; completion does not force another campaign.

09 / The Choir Below arc

Three keyed adventures for two to four rank 6-10 explorers. The arc begins as a practical harbor rescue, follows the origin of an obsolete guidance channel through a preservation habitat, and reaches the inhabited Halcyon engine. Its mysteries concern evidence, stewardship and who gets to decide a route's future. The arc does not reveal that one Pantheon is secretly correct.

Use core task progress 1/2/3 for partial/full/exceptional success. Before a risky task state the actual failure consequence; absent a keyed exception use no progress +1 Strain. Do not add another attack. Announced round-end countdowns advance once while their emergency is active, never again for the same failed task. Enemies use the Frontier Bestiary and one ordinary activation each.

Adventure 11: The Choir Below



Place: Threnody Basin. **Rank:** 6-7. **Opening:** Vey Saren offers 4 Supply to recover a trapped survey team and stop an experiment drawing reactive fog toward the harbor. A sample, map and interview all suggest that the “song” is a layered engineered signal. Residents may still consider it sacred because it preserves their families' work.

People: Vey is an Order engineer trying to preserve the harbor. Cantor Len Orr, an unmodified human Divinity performer, has recorded the sea without authorizing the experiment. Dr. Cass, a Gene-Crafted human secular researcher, altered the signal to find a route and now wants the injured apprentice rescued before any inquiry.

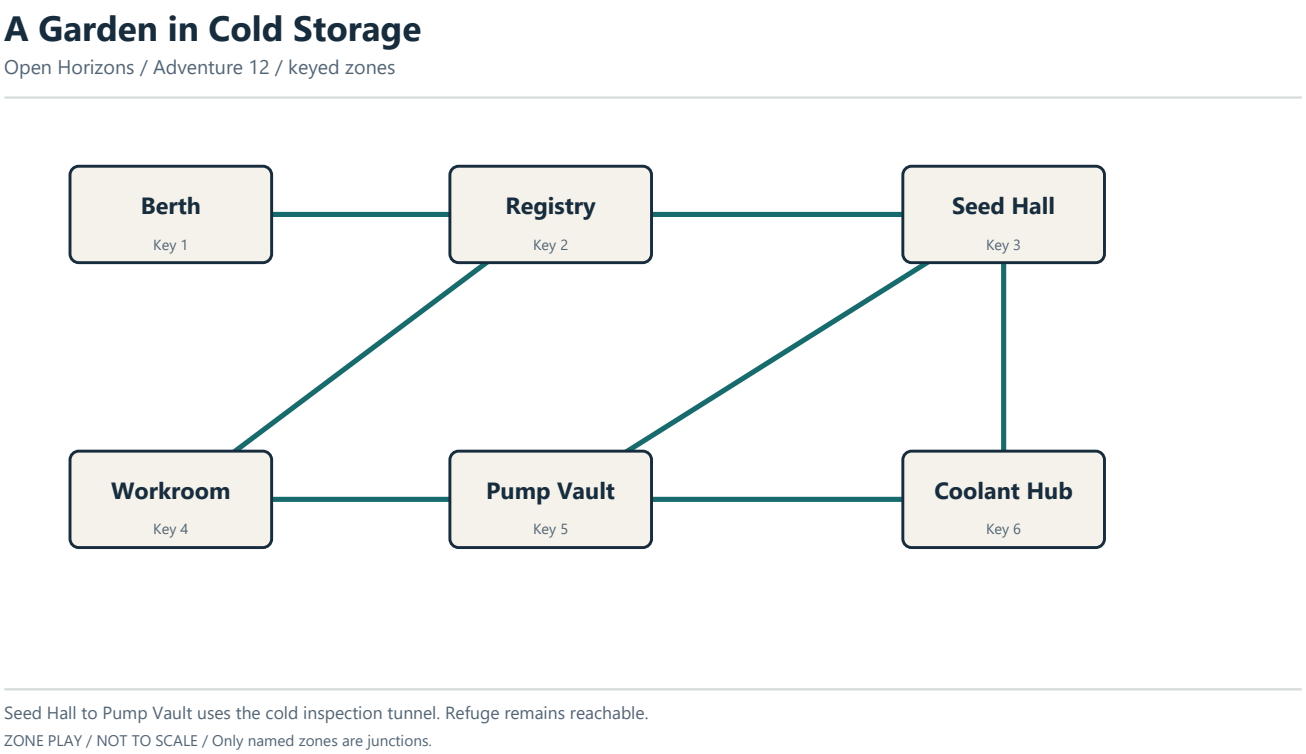
Map: Harbor -> Sound Dock -> Research Float -> Intake. Sound Dock -> Reef Passage -> Shelter. Reef Passage ↔ Intake. Shelter ↔ Research Float by a narrow tethered surface walkway. Water zones require compatible breathing or vehicles; the surface walkway gives a longer dry approach.

1. **Harbor:** Vey's instrument comparison identifies the exact carrier frequency without rolling. Len offers the original public recording; it lacks the experiment's appended guidance code. Both are willing witnesses if treated as people rather than suspects.
2. **Sound Dock:** a damaged Tide Skiff can be made serviceable by **Repair 2** or replaced through a 3-Supply local rental deposit, returned if intact. An unattended receiver carries a current location ping from the trapped team. No gate depends on one character having a specific Discipline.
3. **Research Float:** two conscious injured researchers and one stabilized Downed apprentice need extraction. Ordinary evacuation or the explicit Life at the Edge rite can help; routine healing cannot revive the apprentice. The experiment log names Winter Index as the sample's origin and is freely copied once reached.
4. **Reef Passage:** two Choir Reef Colonies occupy different water zones. For three/four PCs activate at most one Colony and one Hunger Fog at a time. For a duet use one Colony only. The colonies can be calmed by reducing industrial vibration, opening a quieter route or using the environmental controls at the Float.
5. **Shelter:** intact air refuge for six. A local caretaker offers a safe place for the rescued team but needs the intake preserved. A copied maintenance chart supplies the second independent Winter Index lead if the main log is lost.
6. **Intake:** a **Signal Decoupling 6** task stops the lure without destroying the harbor feed. Alternately physically disconnect the experimental transmitter, sacrificing its gathered data but leaving water pumps intact. The relevant cable is labeled on the maintenance chart and visible to ordinary examination.

Pressure: once the transmitter is touched or deliberately retuned, advance **Fog at Intake 6** once per active emergency round. At 6 the harbor intake closes safely for a watch and inhabitants ration water; no automatic mass death. Successful decoupling pauses the clock permanently for this incident. A failed task does not advance it a second time. Rescue and decoupling can proceed in parallel.

Outcomes: rescue plus stopping the lure earns 4 Supply; either achieved alone earns 3 as stated before acceptance. Preserving data gives a clearer Halcyon route but is optional. Cass admits modifying the signal if shown the original recording or their own log; no compelled confession is required. Winter Index can independently verify the sample's shipping record, so a lost log never ends the arc.

Adventure 12: A Garden in Cold Storage



Place: Winter Index. **Rank:** 7-9. **Opening:** Elian Moss offers a studied relic loan and 3 Supply for repairing a cooling bypass before the habitat must discard one collection. The crew also seeks the preserved Halcyon sample and its transport record. The staff will negotiate access; they will not let visitors take irreplaceable biological material without a preservation plan.

People: Elian puts safe staff conditions first. Archive custodian Tem, an Asteri mechanical person and Ancients observer, wants the sample to return to its ecosystem. Food coordinator Daro Venn, an augmented human secular cooperative member, fears that research priorities will consume the agricultural reserve. These are reconcilable needs if the bypass can be restored.

Map: Berth -> Registry -> Seed Hall -> Coolant Hub. Registry -> Workroom -> Pump Vault -> Coolant Hub. Seed Hall ↔ Pump Vault through an insulated inspection tunnel. All have ordinary air except the announced cold inspection tunnel, requiring compatible protection.

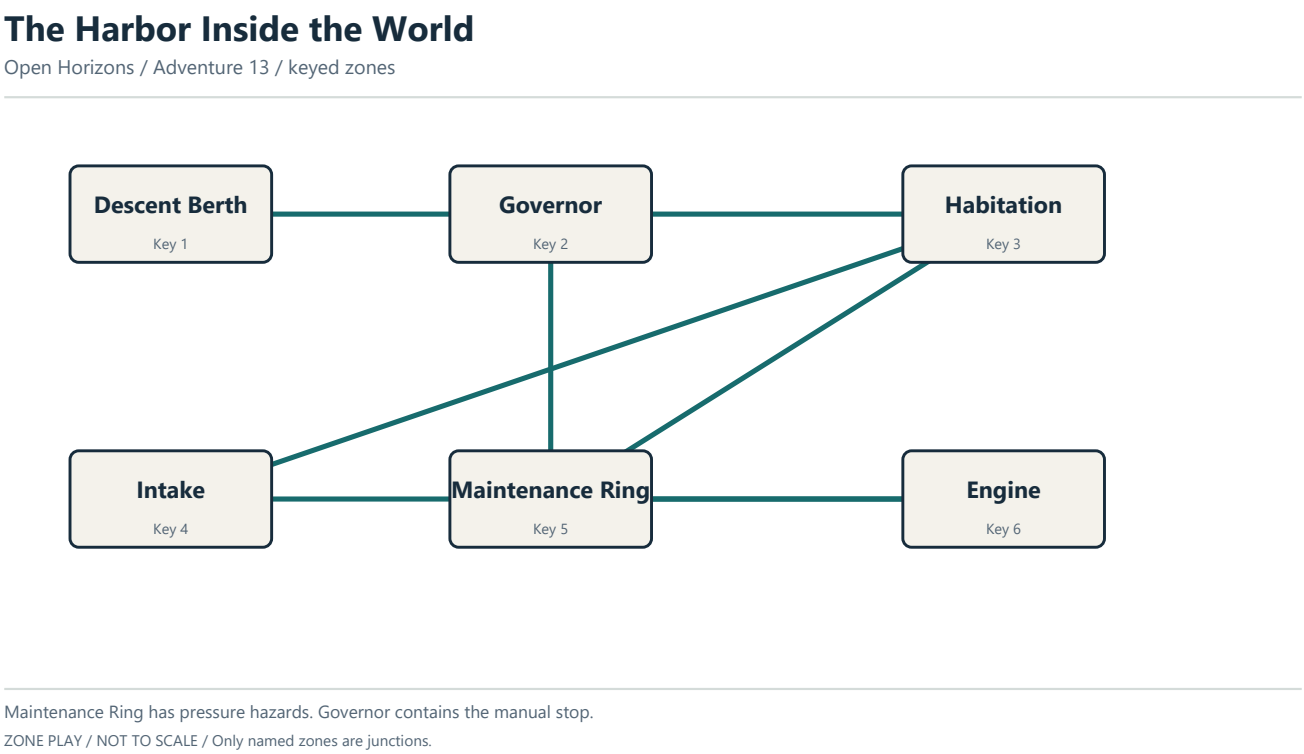
1. **Berth:** staff state the cooling deadline and show a safe refuge. The crew can borrow ordinary thermal wraps; these cover cold, not pressure, vacuum or weapons. The archive can transmit a sample checksum without removing the organism.
2. **Registry:** the public transport record supplies Halcyon's approach coordinates. A valid research agreement, proof of the Basin emergency or a concrete sample-return plan secures an interview with Tem. No mandatory burglary or worship test.
3. **Seed Hall:** labeled collections explain the actual capacity choice. A 2-segment inventory task identifies that one supposedly essential line is already empty; this reduces the bypass repair from 6 to 4 by allowing a safe temporary reroute. Failure adds 1 Strain and consumes no extra collection automatically.

4. **Workroom:** a Rescue Automaton has classified a compatible sleeping worker as injured and is preparing to move them into the wrong refuge. A corrected environmental reading or 2-segment interface task resolves it; destroying it is possible but unnecessary. The worker knows an ordinary manual pump release.
5. **Pump Vault:** a stuck Salvage Walker was stripping an obsolete pump when cooling failed. It has Guard 10, armor 1, close damage 3; disconnect its visible power lead, provide the current exclusion map or defeat it. For four PCs add one Maintenance Spider; for a duet use only the Spider and omit the Walker. The pump is recovered intact if its mounting is released rather than cut.
6. **Coolant Hub:** complete **Bypass 6**, reduced to 4 with the Seed Hall finding or manual release. Powering down one collection also buys a safe watch but places that collection under a visible preservation limit. A portable Cold Vault or the Seed Beyond Winter rite can protect the specific Halcyon sample, not the entire habitat.

Pressure: Cooling Reserve 8, starting at 2. Advance once per completed risky repair/task round only after entering the failing coolant system; do not count ordinary conversation as rounds. At 8 staff deliberately isolate one agreed collection, preserving people and remaining stock. The crew can still finish repair and negotiate what can be restored. No surprise "all seeds die" on a single failure.

Outcomes: repair earns 3 Supply and a one-expedition loan of one studied relic from the armory. A loan needs a named return arrangement; it is not free ownership of the whole library. Tem releases either a preserved sample with a credible transport plan or its records plus a local specialist who can advise by radio. The coordinates, sample label and worker's old maintenance chart each point to Halcyon independently.

Adventure 13: The Harbor Inside the World



Place: Halcyon Deep. **Rank:** 9-10; optional return at legendary ranks. **Opening:** Suri An requests repair of the intake and help convening residents and returning claimants. The habitat engine can redirect one local transport corridor to an existing compatible port. It cannot open a route to any imagined world. Several communities have legitimate claims to its future.

People: Suri wants the present residents protected. Tem or their remote representative seeks a responsible return of the sample. Captain Senn, a human Symbiotic navigator and Order architect, represents a convoy whose old charter promised a berth here. Community delegate Ral, a Nacrean Divinity lay observer, fears that opening the corridor will remove residents' control over their own water system.

Map: Descent Berth -> Governor -> Habitation -> Intake. Governor -> Maintenance Ring -> Engine. Intake ↔ Engine. Habitation ↔ Maintenance Ring. The Ring has marked pressure hazards; ordinary interior zones have compatible public life support. The deeper world is not accessible without another expedition.

1. **Descent Berth:** a recovered approach record from Winter Index or Quiet Glass provides ordinary docking instructions. Without one, a 4-segment Scan/navigation task finds the safe channel, costing a watch rather than immediate Hull damage on failure. State the Stores return requirement before descent.
2. **Governor:** obsolete ownership credentials prevent a new docking contract. A 4-segment local override, a recorded present-resident authorization or the original maintenance agreement can open access. The Governor is the Hollow Ark encounter's docking component, not a separate extra enemy vessel.
3. **Habitation:** residents freely offer the current water problem, evacuation needs and two proposed destinations. A public council can agree to emergency intake repair without agreeing on permanent governance. No religious test decides who may speak. Establish a refuge and named representatives before escalating the Engine.
4. **Intake:** complete **Clean Intake 6** using tools, local ecological knowledge or a compatible sample study. The preserved sample gives one evidence fact about filter conditions, not an automatic win. A route task can instead install a temporary bypass, providing one expedition's breathing room while permanent repair remains a project.
5. **Maintenance Ring:** one Phase Scar (Guard 10, armor 1, damage 3 after Charge) blocks the safe work route. A 4-segment regulator task ends it intact; the crew can also isolate its power at the Intake. For a duet reduce the task to 2 and announce every charged zone. For four experienced PCs add one Maintenance Spider, not another elite.
6. **Engine:** three necessary achievements are visible: safe water, a working route calibration and a legitimate operating agreement. Calibration is a 6-segment task after the Ring is safe. Agreement needs actual concessions: berth capacity, maintenance labor, resident veto over water use, a public schedule or a trial period. A negotiation task can resolve a specific remaining uncertainty; it never replaces the other parties' consent.

Pressure: only after calibration begins, run **Pressure Cycle 8**, advancing once at emergency round end. At 8 the Engine closes the route and the crew must retreat to Habitation; safe water work already completed remains. A reachable manual stop at Governor pauses calibration and the countdown, allowing withdrawal without resetting completed repair. No unavoidable ship explosion.

Opposition: if an armed claimant tries to seize the site, use one Veteran Expedition Leader and one Contract Breacher, replacing rather than adding to an active Phase Scar encounter. Both will accept a credible berth and maintenance settlement. The Hollow Ark's ship-scale gun is dormant unless the crew deliberately reactivates that circuit; do not run personal and ship attacks simultaneously against the same PC action sequence.

Outcomes: a safe trial corridor with resident consent earns 4 Supply, one concrete Legacy contact and a changed route on the atlas. A repaired intake with the corridor closed is also a successful civic outcome, earning 3 Supply and the opportunity to return. Seizing control by force creates a continuing occupied habitat and accountability problem; it does not make the inhabitants automatic loyal followers. The next legendary undertaking can establish a commons, rescue network or research exchange using the long-campaign rules.

10 / Campaign procedures

These procedures turn the atlas into repeatable play. They use the same small clocks, Supply and relationships as the core. A procedure is a way to make stakes clear, not a demand to roll whenever characters speak, travel or examine an ordinary object. Never charge several clocks for the same elapsed interval unless each was explicitly announced as an independent process.

Research that produces adventures

Write a concrete question and the decision its answer will inform. Name three different evidence routes: a physical source, a person and a record. At least one basic clue from each reachable route is automatic. A task roll concerns danger, precision or time, never whether the whole adventure has a lead.

Scope	Requirement	Task clock	Result
Field identification	Sample, appropriate tool and one quiet minute	None unless danger interrupts	Known substance/function or a specific reason it is unfamiliar
Site investigation	Reachable evidence and an investigative approach	4	One answer plus its observable support; failed attempts take the announced risk
Complex technical study	Working facility, access and one watch	6	A usable design constraint, safe test or repair procedure, not an unlimited invention
Lost-route reconstruction	Two independent genuine records and a facility	8 over several watches	A testable local route and its known hazard; travel still costs time and Stores

Completing a research clock answers the named question. If the evidence is insufficient, discover the concrete missing source before committing to repeated rolls. Do not secretly make the answer impossible after the players complete all requirements. A false source produces a contradiction the crew can investigate; it does not make the Guide's narration universally untrustworthy.

Failure menu: contamination of one identified sample; a visible device lockout; one additional watch; 1 Strain from an exposed examination; alerting a named custodian. Choose one fitting consequence in advance. Destroying the only clue is unsuitable unless alternate routes already exist. Ten unchanged samples are not ten independent attempts to farm exceptional results.

Negotiation with actual terms

Give each negotiating party a desired outcome, a minimum need, a fear, an asset and one person who can commit it. State what the crew knows freely. The player proposes a concrete concession or approach; the NPC answers according to its actual priorities. Roleplaying a speech is optional: stating the intent and offer is enough.

Use a single Presence roll for one uncertain request that an NPC could plausibly accept. For a larger settlement use a 4- or 6-segment agreement clock, one distinct unresolved issue per task. Repeating the same demand without changing circumstances earns no new roll. Partial progress may require a named concession; failure may consume a watch or reveal a genuine objection. No roll overrides a stated absolute boundary, creates sincere belief or transfers a community's government.

Before committing an agreement, list who provides what, when, how compliance is observed and how parties may leave or appeal. A signed agreement can still be broken; the consequence is a changed relationship or specific material dispute, not loss of all free will. Core Trust rises at most once/adventure for meaningful commitments. A friendly speaker cannot farm Trust by signing many trivial agreements.

Example: the harbor needs a weather feed, the relay caretaker needs maintenance labor, and residents reject a private docking tax. A public rotating work roster meets all three without anyone converting. Presence may settle whether the first trial lasts a week or a month; it cannot erase the labor cost or secretly compel consent.

Dangerous journeys

Before departure identify destination, route legs, Stores required, known fuel stops and one announced uncertainty. Ordinary charted travel is automatic. If a route is dangerous, offer at least two approaches with concrete prices: an extra leg, one watch surveying, a permit, a vehicle or a risk to resolve. A navigation roll should choose what happens on a meaningful obstacle, not repeatedly tax every safe leg.

On arrival decide whether the crew has enough Stores to return or reach another fuel stop. Make available local work, a negotiated tow or a public emergency request if they knowingly run short. Stranding can become an adventure; it need not become an unannounced irreversible dead end. Buying fuel remains 1 Supply per Stores and cannot be reversed into free Supply.

d6	Route obstacle	Two immediate approaches
1	Drifting maintenance debris	Spend one watch mapping a bypass, or attempt a 4-segment navigation task through a visible safe corridor
2	Closed public relay	Request a reachable appeal, or take the announced extra-leg route
3	Migrating non-sapient life	Wait a watch with a forecast, or take a physically separate charted lane
4	Distress call	Divert to a stated rescue site, or relay the genuine coordinates and accept the actual delay before help arrives
5	Incomplete route chart	Compare a reachable public source, or send a suited survey team from a safe stopping point
6	Convoy dispute	Offer a specific passage arrangement, or separate from the convoy and bear its stated escort risk

A faction project turn

Use after a completed adventure or one clearly elapsed downtime week, whichever the campaign has chosen. It is optional for crews who want institutional consequences; it does not replace the core territorial Influence module or make religious life a conquest game.

1. Name at most three active institutions and one **4-segment project** each. Record its aim, visible sign, material requirement and way to interrupt or redirect it. Announce those that the crew could reasonably know.
2. Resolve the crew's normal individual downtime projects. The crew may also support **one shared institutional undertaking**, requiring a concrete scene, resource or negotiated contribution; no automatic free task rolls for every owned base.

3. Advance each institution's project by 1 only if it retains its required resource and no resolved crew action prevented it. A specific success may add one additional progress once this turn. No unlimited progress from repeating a letter or donation.
4. At completion, make the stated physical or social change. Offer a new situation and a chance to respond. A completed project does not retroactively cancel an expedition already resolved.

Institution project	Required resource	Completion / intervention
Harbor public tug roster	A staffed repair berth	One known port gains scheduled rescue access; negotiate staffing or repair the berth
Private landing toll	Recognized charter hearing	A named berth charges one agreed fee; contest the charter, provide an alternative berth or negotiate exemptions
Seed-house expansion	Compatible shelter and material delivery	Six more guests can rest; bring materials or expose an unsafe location
Credential migration	Accessible old records	One site accepts new civilian formats; recover originals or agree a temporary manual review
Closed signal license	Control of one relay	A named ordinary channel becomes restricted; open another transmitter, appeal or interrupt a specific contract
Free clinic workroom	Compatible kit and willing practitioners	Ordinary wound care becomes reachable at a named port, still costing materials/time; fund tools or recruit volunteers

Institutions can change leaders, split or abandon projects when circumstances change. They do not always pursue the most hostile possible option. A missed turn is not permission to destroy the crew's home in a surprise paragraph.

Settlements as playable places

Create five public locations: arrival point, ordinary worksite, meeting place, refuge and contested facility. Connect them by at least two routes so the crew can choose an approach. Give three residents different jobs and beliefs. Name a useful service the settlement genuinely provides and a need it cannot currently meet.

Use a **Need clock 4 or 6** only for a concrete shared objective such as restoring a pump. It gains normal task progress from meaningful work. Need is not a morality score, a conversion bar or an abstract population mood. At completion the named service works. Governing it still needs agreement.

Building a new facility requires a suitable site, permission, 4 Supply, two downtime intervals and a 6-segment preparation task spread across those intervals. The facility supplies one ordinary service: treatment space, archive access, a workshop or compatible refuge. It grants no passive Supply, free staff or defense immunity. Repairs/replacement and control disputes arise through established events rather than arbitrary upkeep every session.

Encounter recipes

Select an objective before selecting opponents. Give every dangerous scene a retreat route and one interaction that can alter its pressure. The following starting recipes assume three/four PCs; reduce to one regular at a time for a duet. They are testable starting points, not certified balanced encounter budgets.

Recipe	Opposition	Terrain / objective
Quiet entry	Customs Lens +one Dockside Lookout	Two approaches, ordinary credentials and an Inspection clock that summons a conversation before combat
Rescue under load	Maintenance Spider +environmental 6-countdown	Three stranded people, a reachable safe refuge and a shutdown tool
Contract confrontation	Contract Breacher +Charter Bailiff	A real contested order, a public appeal and a secured object both sides want intact
Wild crossing	Glassback Grazer +Coilwing Scavenger	A salt-lick route, an alternate path and a loose essential object
Facility failure	Phase Scar alone	Two regulator controls, clearly marked charge zones and a noncombat shutdown task
Data preservation	Archive Sentinel +Maintenance Spider	Two accessible terminals, a legitimate owner and a power isolation choice
Boarding scramble	Veteran Expedition Leader +one Contract Breacher	A visible retreat hatch, a rescue target and an ordinary contract that can be renegotiated
Epic machinery	Cathedral Walker alone	Two regulators, a boarding stair and a caretaker with a concrete reason to stop

When a recipe proves too easy, add a changing objective, separated work positions or a visible arriving wave. Do not silently add armor, free reactions or repeated damage after every PC miss. When too hard, let enemy motives support retreat, surrender or negotiation; adjust the next scene openly rather than secretly rewriting every rolled result.

Two long-campaign paths

The Public Route: begin at rank 2 with The Broken Beacon, continue through Wages in the Sealed Bay and Who Owns the Warning, then run the Choir Below arc when the crew reaches its intended range. Between keyed adventures, use personal threads and atlas jobs to earn intervening milestones. At rank 11 choose who maintains a newly opened route. At ranks 12-16 complete three institutional expeditions: secure a refuge, establish a public chart exchange and resolve a disputed convoy charter. At ranks 17-20 attempt the crew's three-part Legacy undertaking. Those later expeditions are preparation frameworks, not additional fully keyed adventures.

The Returning Garden: begin with a rank-6 expedition at Threnody, then Winter and Halcyon. The crew must choose what sample, evidence and ecological responsibility travel together. Later framework expeditions revisit Stillwater's ring, Viridian's displaced animals and Saffron's occupied modules. A legendary conclusion can create a consent-based preservation network across the twelve destinations, with distinct local custodians. No rite turns an inhabited world into a reward to be owned.

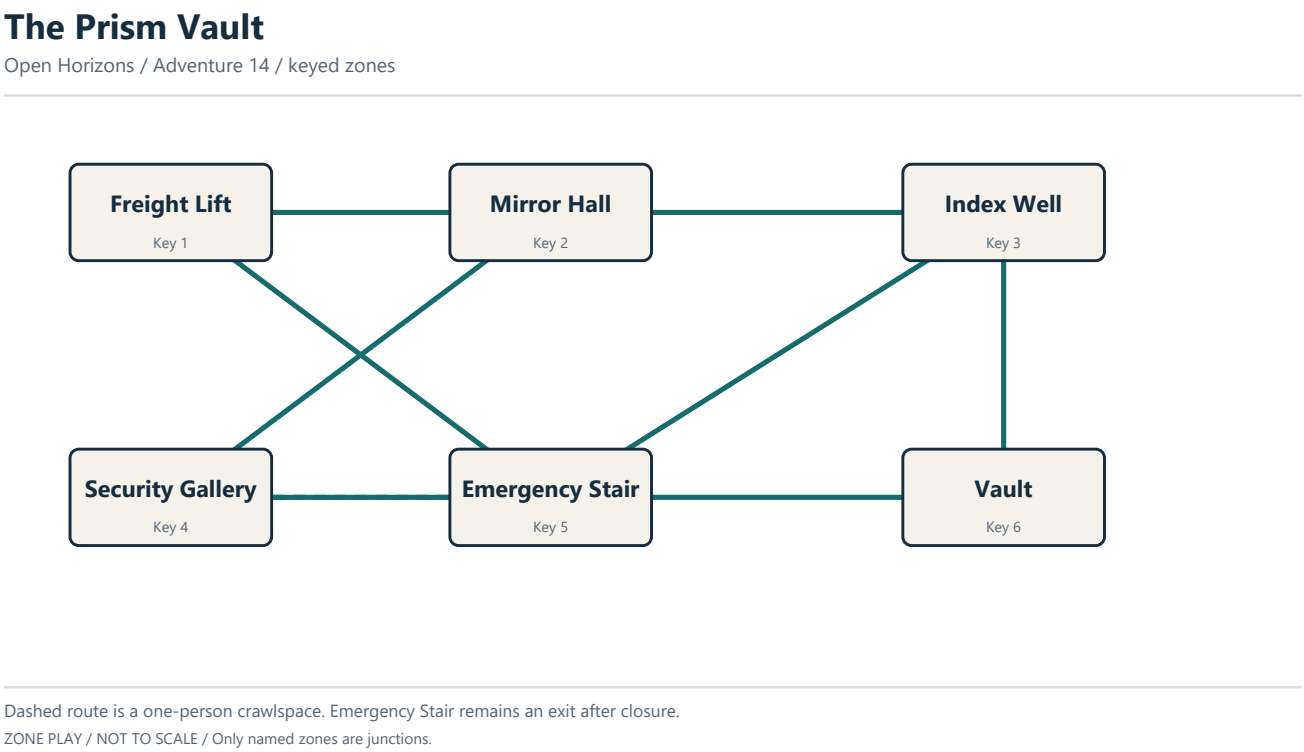
Session preparation sheet

Write: current objective; two reachable approaches; three sources for the essential clue; one NPC's minimum need; one ordinary useful object; one announced pressure and exact trigger; opposition activations; safe retreat; reward; consequences that remain if the crew leaves. End with two new reachable leads and a question for one personal thread. If a prepared fact would negate a creative valid solution, revise the situation while preserving already established evidence rather than forcing the crew back onto a script.

11 / Independent expeditions

Three additional keyed adventures vary the campaign: a relic-vault expedition, a wilderness hunt with rival crews, and a legendary siege evacuation. They can interrupt either frontier arc or stand alone. They use the same core tasks, 1/2/3 progress and one enemy activation per creature. Ordinary failed hazardous tasks add 1 Strain unless a keyed risk says otherwise; announce the risk first. Optional treasure rewards replace, rather than multiply, the stated contract reward when indicated.

Adventure 14: The Prism Vault



Place: Lacuna Archive, abandoned lower deposit vault. **Rank:** 4-6. **Opening:** an independent depositor offers 3 Supply to retrieve a sealed research case before a rival company removes the entire cabinet. The deposit agreement grants retrieval of that case only. Other objects have identifiable owners or disputed status, creating choices rather than free unlimited loot.

People: depositor Ada Voss, an augmented human scientist, wants the field notes needed to complete a missing expedition's route. Rival captain Tess-of-Iron, a Tessari Corsair, has a legitimate recovery contract for a different cabinet. Archive caretaker Iren, an unmodified human Order observer, wants a functional emergency exit and will accept a jointly recorded inventory.

Map: Freight Lift -> Mirror Hall -> Index Well -> Vault. Mirror Hall -> Security Gallery -> Vault. Index Well -> Emergency Stair -> Freight Lift. Security Gallery ↔ Emergency Stair through a crawlspace that fits one human-scale suited person at a time. The Mirror Hall has moveable ordinary cover screens.

1. **Freight Lift:** a damaged visitor slate names the research case and cabinet coordinates freely. Its map also marks the Emergency Stair. A visible floor plate sinks slightly under heavy load; an ordinary brace or staying on its clearly marked

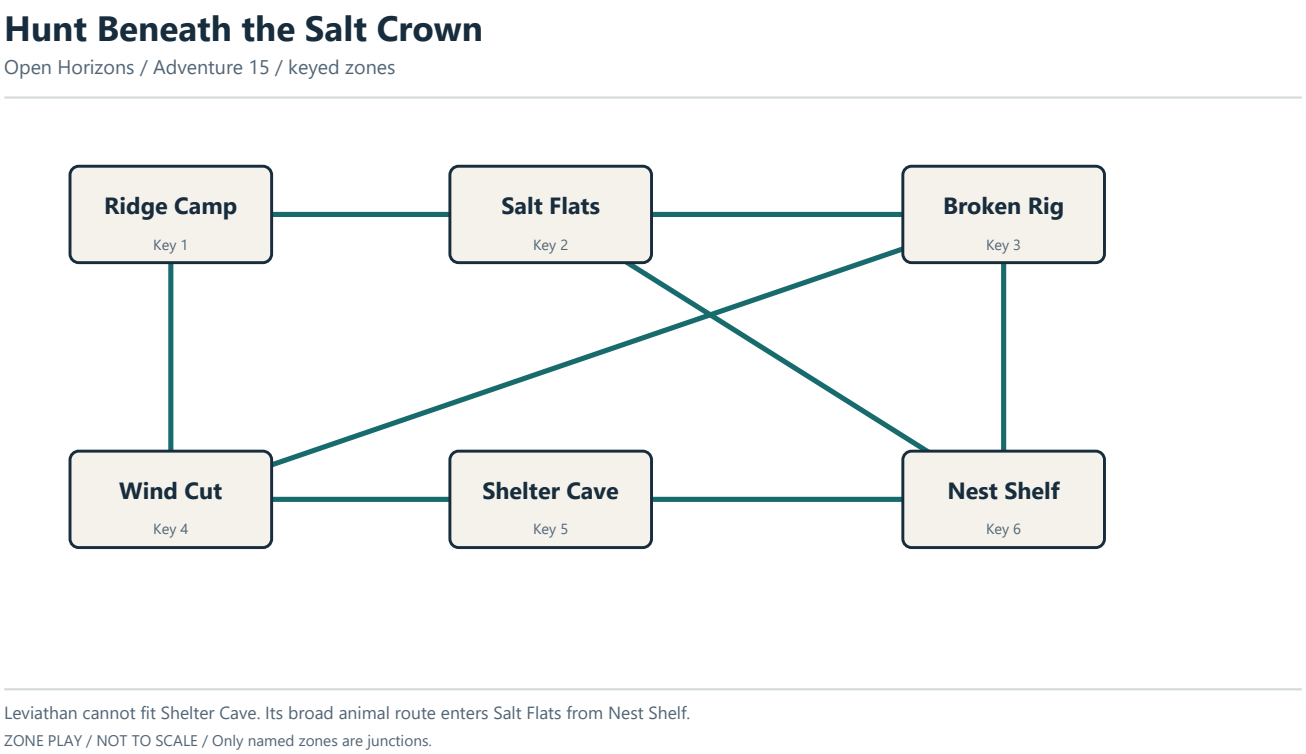
service edge avoids triggering the lift's alarm. Forcing the whole lift takes a 4-segment tool task with noise as the failure risk.

2. **Mirror Hall:** two Mirror Blooms project old visitor silhouettes. Touch, a lamp-angle test or Optical Check distinguishes the projections; they do no damage. A real Coilwing Scavenger has carried a cabinet key onto a reachable perch. Offer reflective scrap, climb or bypass the key through a later latch task. Destroying every image does not solve the cabinet access.
3. **Index Well:** a descending ladder leads to a readable deposit directory. The ladder's missing rung is visible before descent. A 2-segment tether task secures it; rushing without a tether risks a normal defended damage-2 fall once. The directory reveals that the case belongs to Ada and the neighboring cabinet to Tess's client. It also identifies a marked unclaimed tool cache worth 2 Supply after sale, not per drawer.
4. **Security Gallery:** one Archive Sentinel and one Sentry Tripod protect the route. The Tripod's initial arc covers Mirror Hall; the Emergency Stair flanks it. Presenting the directory and valid deposit record shuts down the Sentinel. Otherwise its normal actions and the Tripod's Reorient create a tactical fight. For a duet omit the Sentinel and reduce the cabinet latch to 2.
5. **Emergency Stair:** Tess and one Contract Breacher arrive to recover their cabinet. Show the directory to establish separate objectives, race for the work route or fight after clearly announced hostile intent. Tess uses Veteran Expedition Leader statistics if combat occurs, but replace the Gallery Sentinel with this group rather than running all four threats at once. Her minimum need is an intact lawful cabinet and safe exit.
6. **Vault:** the requested case is readable proof, physically sealed but not magically trapped. Correct key opens it; otherwise a 4-segment careful tool task does. A visible charged conductor across the neighboring passage threatens damage 2 if touched; isolate it at the labeled wall switch or use a long ordinary tool. A marked unclaimed relic locker contains one studied Copper Witness or Thread Compass, chosen by the Guide. Ada will accept that relic in place of her 3-Supply payment if the crew wants to purchase its claim legitimately.

Pressure: Recovery Window 6 advances once per noisy breach, forced cabinet opening or combat round after the first alarm. These are alternative triggers in a round: advance at most once that round. At 6 an independent archive closure seals the Freight Lift; the Emergency Stair remains an exit. A legal joint recovery order pauses the closure if transmitted from the Well. A lost key or failed task never removes all exits.

Outcomes: delivering the requested intact case earns 3 Supply, plus the optional single 2-Supply cache if found and sold. A chosen relic replaces the 3 payment. Taking others' cabinets creates a specific claimant and restitution problem; it does not curse the crew universally. A recovered expedition chart points toward Saffron Wreck or a personal thread selected before play.

Adventure 15: Hunt Beneath the Salt Crown



Place: the uninhabited ridge beyond Viridian Steps. **Rank:** 7-9. **Opening:** a survey crew is missing near a Dune Sail Leviathan migration. A sponsor offers 4 Supply for rescuing survivors and retrieving a genuine recorder. A competing trophy crew offers an additional kill bonus, but its terms are separate and public. The animal is dangerous, not secretly harmless; rescuers may need to fight it while deciding whether removing its embedded beacon can end the pursuit.

People: local guide Nae, an Ilyri Warden, knows the dry routes and wants two missing apprentices found. Trophy captain Pell Jaro, a human mechanical Corsair, wants a rare sail plate for a collector and will negotiate over a naturally shed one. Survivor En, a Koruun Surveyor, accidentally attached the painful beacon while testing migration instruments.

Map: Ridge Camp -> Salt Flats -> Broken Rig -> Nest Shelf. Ridge Camp -> Wind Cut -> Shelter Cave -> Nest Shelf. Wind Cut ↔ Broken Rig. Nest Shelf is elevated except for one broad animal route into the Flats; ordinary PCs can use the narrow Cave approach. The Leviathan cannot fit the Cave.

1. **Ridge Camp:** Nae supplies a real weather forecast and a marked cave entrance freely. A Glassback Grazer blocks a salt lick on the shortest path; opening another lane, waiting or ordinary nonlethal deterrence clears it. Killing it is not necessary for a route clue.
2. **Salt Flats:** the missing team's visible trail leads to Broken Rig. A shimmering crust warns of unstable footing; use a 2-segment route task, vehicle anchors or Equal Footing for individual crossings. Rushing the marked unstable area risks one normal defended damage-2 fall, not automatic capture. A naturally shed sail plate lies off the trail and can satisfy Pell if retrieved without damaging it.
3. **Broken Rig:** the recorder freely explains the embedded beacon and identifies its compatible release tool. That tool is pinned under a strut: a 4-segment lifting/cutting task recovers it. Two conscious survivors shelter in the rig; one has an ordinary untreated wound but is not automatically Downed. Protect them from the next announced Sand Wake or escort them through Wind Cut.

4. **Wind Cut:** Pell's crew is setting a visible net across the migration route. Pell uses Veteran Expedition Leader statistics and has one Contract Breacher. They accept a genuine shed plate, a specific alternative reward or evidence that their net will trap the survivors. If they fight, their objective is possession of the plate/recorder, not exterminating the PCs. For a duet use Pell alone and allow Nae as the core companion.
5. **Shelter Cave:** safe refuge from the Leviathan, with an anchored workbench and old migration marks. These marks identify when the animal passes beneath Nest Shelf. The crew can establish a 2-segment timing plan, removing the need to chase it across open ground; it does not eliminate the later extraction risk.
6. **Nest Shelf:** confront the Dune Sail Leviathan: Guard 14, armor 1, close damage 3 to at most two targets, normal Sand Wake telegraph. Removing the embedded beacon needs **Release 4**, requiring the recovered tool and a reachable work position while others occupy or distract it. Defeating it also ends the immediate threat. Successful release causes it to retreat through the open broad route; if that route is blocked it waits one activation before forcing a way through normally.

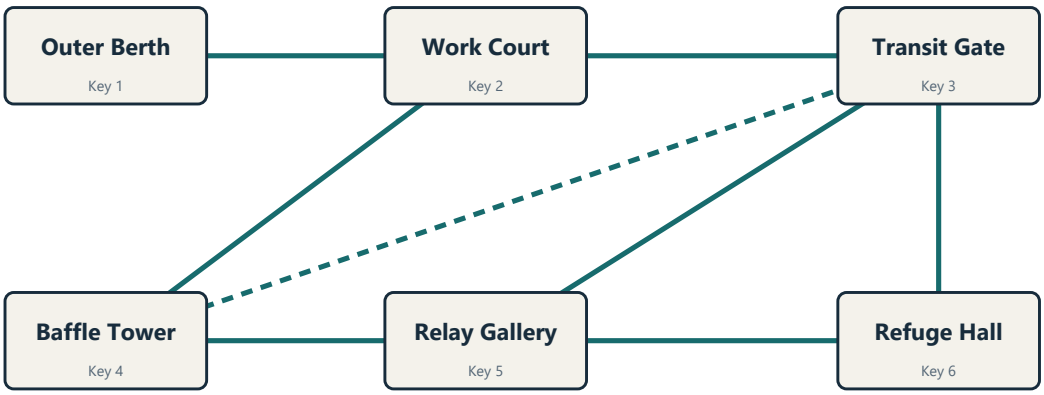
Pressure: Approaching Front 6 advances once per completed exploration watch. Once the final exposed confrontation begins, advance once every two full combat rounds instead, never for the same interval twice. At 6 the Flats route closes and everyone must use the Cave/Wind Cut route or shelter until weather clears. Announce the transition and remaining time. Do not run a separate automatic Leviathan attack at countdown completion.

Outcomes: returning survivors and recorder earns 4 Supply. Returning either earns 3 under the stated contract; another reachable search lead remains for the missing objective. Pell's separate bonus is one studied Counterweight Ring for an intact claimed sail plate; the naturally shed plate qualifies if verified. No extra reward is paid for killing every creature. Nae can become a Warden teacher and the migration map can support a later frontier project.

Adventure 16: Nine Gates at Dawn

Nine Gates at Dawn

Open Horizons / Adventure 16 / keyed zones



Dashed span exists only after repair. Resolve ship approach before starting ground rounds.

ZONE PLAY / NOT TO SCALE / Only named zones are junctions.

Place: Ashfall Harbor during an armed commercial seizure and ash emergency. **Rank:** 17-20. **Opening:** the crew's established refuge or partner institution receives a demand to surrender the public approach controls. A private

commander claims an old charter and deploys a Siege Rig while an ash front threatens an unfinished evacuation. The legendary objective is to keep the port usable and its people represented, not to win a larger hit-point contest.

People: Inspector Sella coordinates repairs; refugee representative Mera insists passengers choose their destination; Commander Kell Varo, a biological human and secular contract officer, believes a disciplined seizure prevents panic. Kell's own employer has not approved firing on occupied shelters. A public record of that restriction can change their orders. Followers of all three Pantheons stand on both sides of the charter dispute.

Map: Outer Berth -> Work Court -> Transit Gate -> Refuge Hall. Work Court -> Baffle Tower -> Relay Gallery -> Refuge Hall. Transit Gate ↔ Relay Gallery. An elevated service span connects Baffle Tower to Transit Gate only after repaired. Ordinary cover occupies Court and Gate. Residents remain in Hall until an actual safe route is established.

1. **Outer Berth:** a Refuge Convoy Tug is ready but requires a public route window. If a hostile Customs Cutter contests the berth, run one core ship encounter first: negotiate inspection terms, force a lawful stand-off or escape/disable normally. Once PCs enter the ground scene, stop ship rounds; do not add gunfire damage to personal turns. For a duet resolve this as an announced negotiation or single 4-segment station objective, without simultaneous ground pressure.
2. **Work Court:** Kell offers supervised evacuation in exchange for sole control of the relay. PCs can propose temporary joint custody, present the employer restriction or refuse. If fighting begins, use one Veteran Expedition Leader and one Contract Breacher here, replacing the Siege Rig encounter until the crew reaches Gate. Their retreat route stays open unless players deliberately close it.
3. **Transit Gate:** the Ashfall Siege Rig blocks the direct exit: core Guard 14, armor 1, launcher damage 3, loader and track components Guard 4 each. Components have the listed mechanical release tasks. It warns with Range Marker before a two-target shot. Disabling the loader opens a physical passage; disabling the track allows routing evacuees around it. A signed ceasefire also lets its crew withdraw. One Rig activation per round.
4. **Baffle Tower: Stabilize Baffles 6** needs tools, surviving power and a safe work position. Completing it buys one extra emergency round without resetting the countdown. Rebuild the Span can create the elevated bypass; Arrest the Cascade can delay a secondary brace failure; ordinary winches and a longer 8-segment repair are valid alternatives. Each listed benefit applies once; no unlimited time from repeating a rite.
5. **Relay Gallery:** the employer's actual restriction is freely readable in a public cached message once reached. **Public Route 6** restores an ordinary approach window with enough context to prevent the false beacon incident recurring. Communion of Strangers can establish understandable terms but cannot compel Kell to sign. Covenant Engine can stabilize an intact utility circuit, not replace destroyed hardware or complete this task automatically.
6. **Refuge Hall:** the final choice concerns destination and caretaker. Complete **Evacuate 6** after at least one real route and a ready Tug exist. Tasks represent coordinating different groups, movement and loading; the same declaration cannot generate repeated progress. A Life at the Edge casting can revive an eligible stabilized passenger, and Hearthkeeper preparations can provide receiving shelter if actually recorded earlier. Present residents can also choose to stay if baffles and water remain safe; evacuation is not mandatory conquest disguised as rescue.

Pressure: after the first hostile ground action or a deliberately announced start of evacuation, advance **Ash Wall 10** once per round. At 10 exterior transit pauses and people shelter; the crew can still preserve Hall, negotiate and resume later. At 6 announce falling visibility and the last clear boarding interval; it adds no flat defense penalty. Full baffle repair buys one round by skipping the next advance, once only. Failures do not advance Ash Wall again. The crew can stop fighting by establishing a real truce without canceling the physical storm.

Scaling: duet: Rig alone, component tasks 2, Evacuate 4, normal companion. Four PCs: Rig plus one regular only after Court opposition withdraws. Keep armor 1 and damage 3; do not combine every named threat into one wave.

Outcomes: a freely negotiated route and preserved refuge complete one rank-20 Legacy achievement or award ordinary milestones. Reward: 4 Supply and one named institutional asset. Safe shelter with delayed evacuation is partial success with a repair lead. Forced ownership leaves a charter dispute; victory grants no automatic followers.